



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

FIRST MEETING, 2026

Tuesday, 10th February, 2026

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 2:15 p.m.*

[THE SPEAKER, RT HON ALBAN
SUMANA KINGSFORD BAGBIN, IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

The Speaker: Hon Members, I want to change the order of Business by acknowledging first, the presence of some visitors. You can see the Public Gallery is full to brim and I want to draw your attention to those who are there. We have five institutions being represented here.

I will start by acknowledging on your behalf, the presence of students from Pokuase A.M.E Zion Basic 2 School. They are 150 in number; that is quite a large number. They are from the Trobu Constituency, led by the headteacher, Mrs Kate Osei-Wusu. Please, you are most welcome.

On behalf of your Members of Parliament, the Clerk-to-Parliament and Staff of the Parliamentary Service, I warmly welcome you to your House, the

Parliament House, which you voluntarily and willingly empowered us to represent you in. It is good that you have come to see what we do.

You are warmly welcome; you may resume your seats. We are encouraged by your presence, especially the number 150. I think that is the highest so far on record.

[Pupils of the Pokuase A.M.E Zion Basic 2 School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: We also have students from the Independence Avenue '1' Basic School. They are 65 in number; they are from the Ododiodio Constituency. They are led by the facilitator called Mr Daniel Boye.

On behalf of the Members of Parliament, I also warmly welcome you and as I just stated, your presence is an inspiration to all of us. It is good you are around to learn, so that in future, you do better than what we are doing. So please, you are welcome and you may resume your seats.

[Pupils of the Independence Avenue '1' Basic School were acknowledged.]

The Speaker: We also have students from Gomoa Gyaman Senior High School. They are 78 in number, from the Constituency—they have written Gomoa here. They are coming from the Gomoa Constituency. I do not know which of them. They are led by the head of department, Mr Isaac Wereko. Please, you are also warmly welcome. I think

you can see that they are quite seniors and they are in a better position to appreciate what we are going to do. Please keep on coming. We love to see many of you here on a daily basis. You may resume your seats.

[Students of Gomoa Gyaman SHS were acknowledged]

2:25 p.m.

The Speaker: We have students from Independence Avenue “2” Basic School, also 69 in number coming from the same constituency as Basic 1. They are led by their teacher, Mr Jones Nii Darko Addawou. Please, you are also warmly welcome to your House and I repeat the same as I have already stated to the others. Kindly resume your seats.

[Students of Independence Avenue “2” Basic School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: We have last but not least, the students from Covenant Presbyterian School and they are 33 in number. The school is located in the Ayawaso West Constituency. They are led by a teacher named Mr Emmanuel Bisah. Please, you are warmly welcome. Mr Bisah, are you to my left? Is that Mr Bisah? He is also leading from behind.

Thank you so much. Please keep on coming and you will learn better than we are doing now. You may resume your seats.

[Students of Covenant Presbyterian School were acknowledged]

The Speaker: Hon Members, usually when the numbers are not so

encouraging, I find it difficult to take the roll call. You know, that this is part of the Standing Orders. I also find it difficult these days to let us recite the National Pledge. Are you with me? It is very difficult to keep on calling to recite the National Pledge when what is coming out from your heart is different from what is coming out from your mouth. So, you are not encouraging us to continue to go by our rules. You are not encouraging us and we have these number of children here. So, if I ask us to recite the National Pledge, when they leave, they will be asking their teachers, what are they about? Because the words that we are going to recite is not what we are practising. So, leaders, pass this on. At least whatever Members are to do, they should appear here, start the work, and then they can move on to attend to the other pleasures. But when we came in, the number was only 20. Seven to my left, 13 to my right: twenty.

Hon Members, I have two Formal Communications and this is in compliance to our Standing Orders. One is on the Bill before us, titled Constitution of the Republic of Ghana Amendment Bill, 2025. The other is on the Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill, 2025.

FORMAL COMMUNICATION BY THE SPEAKER

Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill, 2025

Hon Members, Order 187(2) of the Standing Orders, requires that on the

introduction of a Private Member's Bill, the Speaker shall communicate to the House an opinion whether the Bill complies with Article 108 of the Constitution. The Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill, 2025 was initially introduced as the Promotion of Proper Human Sexual Rights and Family Values Bill, 2021 in August 2021. The Bill went through all the enactment processes and was passed by the Eighth Parliament on 28th February, 2024. It was, however, not assented to by the President and therefore lapsed upon the dissolution of the Eighth Parliament. On the inauguration of the Ninth Parliament, I, by correspondence dated 28th January, 2025, referred the Bill to the Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice for review and comments.

The Office of the Attorney General and Ministry of Justice submitted comments on the Bill by a letter dated 7th April, 2025. The comments were referred to the sponsors of the Bill for consideration — Hon Members, when I am giving you information and you keep on talking, then you go out and mislead the people. Please.

As I stated earlier, the comments were referred to the sponsors of the Bill for consideration. Meanwhile, by correspondence dated 25th February, 2025, the following Members indicated their desire to re-introduce the Bill.

1. Hon Samuel Nartey George
2. Hon Emmanuel Kwesi Bedzrah
3. Hon Rev John Ntim Fordjour
4. Hon Helen Ntoso

5. Hon Vincent Ekow Assafuah
6. Hon Alhassan Tampuli Sulemana
7. Hon Rita Naa Odoley Sowah
8. Hon Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama
9. Hon Anthony Mmieh

As required by Standing Order 182, a legal opinion dated 7th March, 2025 was submitted to me on the proposed Bill. I directed the draftsman to process the request in accordance with the rules for introduction in the House. Additionally, in compliance with the requirements of Section 101 (1) of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016, Act 921, the Fiscal Impact Analysis Report on the proposed Bill was duly submitted to me.

2:35 p.m.

Subsequently, I directed that the drafting be redone and the Bill transmitted pursuant to Order 186. Then, I directed the Committee on Private Member's Bill and Private Member's Motion to consider again and advise me on whether the Bill complies with the relevant constitutional provisions.

The Committee observed, and I want to read the observations of the Committee. The Committee observed that:

1. The reintroduced Bill maintains its underlying principles and core objectives.
2. The Bill does not contravene any constitutional provision, particularly Articles 106 and 108 of the 1992 Constitution.

3. The Bill does not contain any provision that seeks to impose taxation or charge on the Consolidated Fund or other public funds of Ghana or impose payment, issue, or withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund.

The Committee, by a unanimous decision, advised that the Bill be introduced in the House.

Hon Members, I have reviewed the Report of the Committee and formed the opinion that the Bill does not impose or alter taxation or a charge on the Consolidated Fund in the manner stipulated in Article 108 of the 1992 Constitution. The Bill has gone through all the processes in accordance with the Standing Orders of the House. I, therefore, direct that the Bill be scheduled by the Business Committee to be presented to the House for consideration. *[Hear! Hear!]*

I was calling your attention because this has been one of the topics in the public arena, and I have heard some of you contribute to the debate without much information, and misled a lot of people. This is the state of the Bill, and we will go through our Standing Orders. We have to comply with our Standing Orders. That is why, by the Standing Orders, I have been enjoined to read this opinion to you. Please convey the same message to your constituents.

Constitution of the Republic of Ghana Amendment Bill, 2025

Hon Members, Order 187 (2) of the Standing Orders requires that, on the introduction of a Private Member's Bill, the Speaker shall communicate to the House an opinion on whether the Bill complies with Article 108 of the 1992 Constitution. Hon Members, the Member for Akim Swedru, Hon Kennedy Osei Nyarko, in the Eighth Parliament, requested assistance to draft and introduce a Private Member's Bill titled: Constitution of the Republic of Ghana Amendment Bill, 2021.

The Bill was taken through the relevant pre-parliamentary procedure and laid before the House on 2nd June, 2022, as the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana Amendment Bill, 2021, and was subsequently referred to the Council of State pursuant to Article 291(2) of the 1992 Constitution. The Council of State, by a letter dated 8th July, 2022, advised me to proceed with the constitutional processes to effect the proposed amendments.

Subsequently, the Bill was successfully taken through the Second Reading Stage. However, it could not proceed to the Consideration Stage prior to the dissolution of the Eighth Parliament. Consequently, the Bill lapsed, and hence the resubmission of the Bill in this Ninth Parliament as the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana Amendment Bill, 2025. By a memo to the Clerk to Parliament dated 12th May, 2025, the sponsor of the Bill formally requested the addition of three sponsors, namely:

1. Hon Kwame Governs Agbodza,
Member of Parliament for Adaklu,
2. Hon Emmanuel Armah-Kofi Buah,
Member of Parliament for
Ellembele, and
3. Hon Davis Opoku, Member of
Parliament for Mpraeso.

Hon Members, in accordance with Standing Order 182, a legal opinion on the proposed Bill was submitted to me, which indicated that the proposal to draft the Bill was within the legislative competence of the House. Additionally, in compliance with the requirements of Section 101 of the Public Financial Management Act, 2016, Act 921, the Fiscal Impact Analysis Report on the proposed Bill was duly submitted to me. The Report indicated that the Bill will not fiscally burden the State in the short term and will result in potential benefits in the long term.

Upon consideration of the legal opinion and the Fiscal Impact Analysis Report, I directed that the request be processed in accordance with the applicable rules governing the introduction of Bills in the House. Subsequent redrafting of the Bill and in pursuance of Order 186, I directed the Committee on Private Member's Bill and Private Member's Motion to consider and advise me on whether the Bill complies with the relevant constitutional provisions. The Committee observed that the Bill complies with the relevant constitutional requirements and unanimously advised that the Constitution of the Republic of Ghana

Amendment Bill, 2025, be introduced before the House.

Hon Members, I have carefully considered the Report of the Committee and have formed the view that the Bill does not impose or alter any taxation nor does it create a charge on the Consolidated Fund within the meaning of Article 108 of the 1992 Constitution. The Bill has duly undergone all the requisite stages in accordance with the Standing Orders of the House. Accordingly, I direct that the Business Committee schedule the Bill for presentation to the House.

So, Business Committee, in your next meeting, please schedule these two Bills and copies will be given to all Members. I want to call on all Members to take time to read the provisions. These are two critical Bills for the consideration of this House. We would take our time to go through them. They will not be rushed through the House, and at the end of the day, we will be addressing the interests of the people we represent.

I thank you all for your attention.

May we now take the item numbered 5, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

2:45 p.m.

VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT

The Speaker: We will start with the *Votes and Proceedings* of Friday, 6th February, 2026.

Hon Members, Page 1...10—

Yes, Hon Afriyie?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

May I respectfully draw your attention to page 10, item 12, paragraph 2, line 2. Mr Speaker, you would notice that there is a quotation mark that has been opened, but the phrase is incomplete. “Or any other person...”, I guess the next word should be “designated”. Mr Speaker, I take motivation from the fact that if you go to paragraph 3 of the same page, line 2, it is properly captured, so I guess the word “designated” has been omitted inadvertently.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Table, kindly crosscheck and make the necessary corrections.

Page 11...18—

Yes, Hon Afriyie?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with respect, page 18, item 3 (ii), Mr Eric Afful, indeed, is an MP but he is not the Minister for Food and Agriculture. He is the Chairperson for the Committee on Economy. But then if it is the Minister for Food and Agriculture that is being referenced, then I guess the appropriate name should be Mr Eric Opoku.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Table, crosscheck with the Clerk to the Committee to confirm

who was present and capture the person who was present, whether it was Mr Eric Afful or Mr Eric Opoku. I think that will come from the Clerk to the Committee.

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Eric Opoku: Mr Speaker, in all sincerity, I was not present. I was not here.

The Speaker: So, your title has been given to Mr Eric Afful. You are hereby—[*Laughter*] Table kindly *delete* “and Minister for Food and Agriculture”.

Page 19...27?

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of the Fourth Sitting, dated Friday, 6th February, 2026, as presented and corrected is adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, the Hon Member who has been very meticulous and always draws our attention to errors on the *Votes and Proceedings*, by that singular act alone qualifies through my discretion to always participate in a number of international conferences. [*Hear! Hear!*] So those of you who say that they are new MPs and do not get the opportunity to contribute, assess yourselves.

We have decided to upload one of our IT facilities soon which would enable us pilot e-voting. Now, all of you have to get your biodata onto the system from where you sit. There are still a few challenges with some seating arrangements. I want to call on the

Leadership to resolve it. If you cannot find a solution, bring it up to me, and I will assist you to do so because we need it urgently. This has delayed uploading of the facility. We need to do e-voting where you do not need to stand up and be counted again. We want to start the pilot. It will be started and connected to my desk so I can identify how the voting is being done. After we have stabilised it, we will link it to all the facilities here so that you can sit where you are and follow the voting pattern. At the end of the day, we will not be depending on the integrity and capabilities of our staff in trying to identify and to count the votes. It will start this Meeting. Please, Leaders, this is the last plea.

We shall resolve this; it is just a small difference between those seated at this end, where we have the merger. We have to settle that one.

Thank you so much for your attention. We now move to the next item. Yes, Deputy Minority Leader.

2:55 p.m.

Ms Patricia Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, the first issue is that we are very grateful that you are taking cognisance of people who participate in ensuring that *Votes and Proceedings* are corrected, but I would like to draw your attention to one of our popular contributors, Prof Nyarko. He also participates, but I do not think you have acknowledged him for that. So, I am drawing your attention to Prof Nyarko's participation in correcting the *Votes and Proceedings*.

The Speaker: You are always here, and you know I have acknowledged Prof Nyarko many times. Last year, I acknowledged him many times. And even early in the year—I know where he sits. He used to sit at that pillar. I have acknowledged him many times and exercised my discretion in his favour many times. He has not shared that with you.

Ms Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, the other issue is also about the sitting arrangement. We have two Members who do not currently have seats, and it is very important that we resolve this. We are seeking your participation in ensuring that everyone is well seated in this Chamber.

Thank you.

The Speaker: Please kindly bring it up. We will resolve it. Within five minutes, we should have the solution to that. Anymore? My attention has been drawn to the fact that we have not taken the *Official Report*. I have a copy of the *Official Report* of Friday, 19th December, 2025. Any corrections? *[Pause]*

[No correction was made to the Official Report of 19th December, 2025.]

Yes, Majority Chief Whip.

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I wish to pray you that we vary the order of Business from taking item numbered 7 to

taking the one under 8. It has been quite difficult to get the Hon Minister for Food and Agriculture. Today that he is here, we can take him quickly.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Minister for Food and Agriculture, you heard him loud and clear. I do not need to repeat it.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: We got the application mounted by the Majority Chief Whip. It is interesting, especially when he prefixes his application with the fact that he has been struggling to get the Minister for Food and Agriculture. The Ministers must come and wait. This is the Parliament of Ghana. So, it is not the case that he is here, so we should vary our order of Business. No, we will vary our order of Business because we want to, not because the Minister is here and that is what I expect him to say. He has been busy moving around the country for obvious reasons, and I commend him.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, indeed, my intention is to say that the Minister of Agriculture has been very busy touring the country and showing that we have a bumper harvest and so, today that he is here, we want to pray that we take his Business quickly. In fact, the prayer is to the Speaker but not the Minority Chief Whip. Mr Speaker did not invite him into this matter.

So, Mr Speaker, we humbly pray for a variation so that we can take the Question standing in the name of the Minister for Food and Agriculture before we come back to item numbered 7.

The Speaker: Definitely, I will grant the application.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we are not objecting. Out of patriotism, we understand and so, we can go by the application.

The Speaker: Majority Chief Whip, you said you have been finding it difficult.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is withdrawn. It is not my intention at all.

The Speaker: The Minority Chief Whip said you have been struggling. They are different things. It is not for you to argue about it. But I just wanted the attention of the Minister to be drawn to that so that he could advise the House what struggle and difficulty they have been having. Have they relayed that to you, Minister?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, it is withdrawn.

The Speaker: No, let the Minister respond.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I want to make a further prayer that before you consider the prayer to vary Business to take item numbered 8. We want to pray to take item numbered 10 so that the Minister for Education will lay the Paper under item numbered 10.

The Speaker: Now, what do you want? Do you want the item numbered 8 first, or do you want item numbered 10 first?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let us take item numbered 10 first.

The Speaker: I will not take his word away from him. Minister for Food and Agriculture, what do you have to say?

Mr Eric Opoku: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity.

Indeed, last week the Majority Chief Whip indicated to me that he has been struggling to reach me by phone because I have been in the field working on the distribution of the *akoko nketenkete* to beneficiaries. [*Hear! Hear!*] I told him that this week, I am supposed to be in Bono East. But I have asked some other colleagues to go and do the distribution on my behalf. Therefore, I will be available in the House. So, he is right in making that statement.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Actually, the work of this House is not subject to the availability of any Minister. Once the work is before us, we can carry on with or without the Ministers. That is why some of them have assistant Ministers, referred to as Deputy Ministers. Apart from that, we can move on without them once they are ready and have submitted the Business to us.

3:05 p.m.

It is for us to do our part and get it through. So, please, we are not

dependent on the availability or non-availability of Hon Ministers. Let us carry on with our Business.

In terms of seniority, the Hon Minister for Education takes precedence. So, I agree with the Hon Majority Chief Whip that we should take the item numbered 10 first, which is the Presentation of Instruments.

Hon Members, the item numbered 10, Presentation of Instruments, Education Regulatory Bodies, (National Teaching Council), Regulation, 2026, by the Minister for Education.

INSTRUMENT

Education Regulatory Bodies (National Teaching Council) Regulation, 2026

*Laid by the Minister for Education.
Referred to the Committee on Subsidiary Legislation.*

The Speaker: We go back to the item numbered 8, Questions.

Mr Dafeamekpor — *rose* —

The Speaker: You want us to take those dealing with the Ministry of Food and Agriculture?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so.

The Speaker: We will start from the Question numbered 433. It stands in the name of the Hon Member of Parliament for Keta, Hon Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, may I mount a prayer on Order 88(3) with the prior authorisation of the Member concerned to seek your permission to ask the Question on his behalf. He is unavoidably not around.

The Speaker: Where did you get that phrase, “unavoidably not present”, for a Member of Parliament?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am still learning. *[Laughter]*

The Speaker: When you read the Standing Orders well, you would see that it applies to the Speaker and not to a Member of Parliament.

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

The Speaker: If your Member is unavoidably absent, you know the Article in the Constitution. They will start applying for the by-election.

Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that would be very dangerous. *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, these are friendly exchanges. We pray that you grant him the permission to ask the Question. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: In other words, you are going to do so for the Questions numbered 433, 428 and 431, which stands in his name.

Mr Afriyie: Exactly so, Mr Speaker. Thank you so much.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF FOOD AND AGRICULTURE

Measures to Control Pests and Diseases in Crops and Livestock

Mr Frank Afriyie (NDC — Afadjato South) on behalf of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (NDC — Keta): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what measures are being taken to control pests and diseases in crops and livestock.

Minister for Food and Agriculture (Mr Eric Opoku): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Plant Protection and Regulatory Services Directorate (PPRSD) plays a crucial role in safeguarding national agriculture by protecting crops from pests, diseases, and invasive species through the underlisted interventions:

Pest Prevention and Early Detection

Objective: Protect crops before pests and diseases cause damage.
Interventions:

- PPRSD implement Phytosanitary inspections at points of entry (airports, seaports, land borders) to prevent pest introduction.

- Conduct surveillance and monitoring programs for early detection of pests (e.g., traps, field surveys, community reporting).
- Maintain and update pest risk databases and pest status records.
- Promote quarantine regulations for imported plants and planting materials.

Pest Risk Analysis (PRA) and Management

Objective: Assess and manage pest threats before they affect agriculture.

Interventions:

- Conduct Pest Risk Assessments to determine the likelihood and potential impact of pest introductions.
- Develop pest management strategies and emergency response plans based on risk profiles.
- Collaborate with trading partners to manage transboundary pest risks.

Emergency Pest Response and Eradication

Objective: Contain or eliminate pest outbreaks to minimise food losses.

Interventions:

- Establish rapid response teams for pest outbreaks (e.g., Fall Armyworm, Papaya Mealy bug, Fruit Flies).

- Develop and implement contingency or eradication plans.
- Provide training and equipment for emergency pest control (e.g., pesticide application, biological control).
- Coordinate with FAO, Centre for Agriculture and Bioscience International (CABI) or regional bodies for technical support.

Farmer Education and Extension Support

Objective: Empower farmers with knowledge and tools to manage pests sustainably.

Interventions:

- Conduct awareness campaigns on pest identification and reporting.
- Train farmers on Integrated Pest Management (IPM) practices.
- Develop guidelines and manuals for safe pesticide use and biological control.
- Develop guidelines, posters and flyers on pest management practices
- Promote community-based surveillance and reporting networks.

Research and Innovation

Objective: Develop science-based solutions for pest management and crop protection.

Interventions:

- Collaborate with universities and research institutes (CABI) for the rearing and releases of biological control agents for pest management.
- Collaborate with Universities and Research Institutes (CSIR, *et cetera*) for the development and release of resistant crop varieties.

Regulatory and Policy Framework

Objective: Provide governance and enforcement for plant health measures.

Interventions:

- Develop and enforce the Plants and Fertilizer Act, 2010 (Act 803) and its Regulations.
- Establish standards for pest control products and inspection services.

Mr Speaker, on livestock health, the Veterinary Services Directorate is implementing a series of strategic interventions to strengthen animal disease prevention, detection, and response across the country.

3:15 p.m.

Key measures include the following:

- Disease Surveillance and Real-Time Reporting EMA-i+ digital

tool nationwide with the support from FAO to facilitate real-time animal disease reporting, early warning, and rapid response at all levels.

- Our Veterinary laboratories across the country are being renovated and equipped with modern diagnostic tools to enable timely and accurate disease diagnosis for prompt outbreak response and control.
- Veterinary staff technical capacity in disease diagnosis, surveillance, and outbreak response, including priority diseases such as Anthrax, Rabies, Zoonotic TB, Aquatic Animal Diseases and Avian Diseases among others.

Mr Speaker, above all, the Ministry is revising the Diseases of Animals Act, 1961 (Act 83) to address emerging disease threats and to strengthen the legal authority for disease control measures, including inspection, quarantine, movement control, and enforcement actions. Also providing training Veterinary Meat Inspectors across the country in accordance with the Meat Inspection Regulations, 2020 (L.I. 2405) to promote compliance with food safety standards at abattoirs and slaughter facilities.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, you have heard the Hon Minister. Hon Member, any further questions?

Mr Afriyie: Rt Hon Speaker, I am so satisfied with the answers provided. Thank you.

The Speaker: Is that the authority they gave you? *[Laughter]*

Hon Members, we move on to the next Question, and the same Hon Member who has the authority will ask that Question, and that is Question numbered 428.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh — *rose* —

Sorry, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we were all here when he mounted his application, and the application was specific to Question 433. Now we are proceeding to Question 428. Is he assuming that permission or authority? Mr Speaker, he should be mounting another application. That is what he should be doing.

The Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, I think at that time your attention was distracted. I actually granted him the permission because all the three Questions stand in the name of that Hon Member and he said he had the authority to ask all the three Questions, so I granted him leave. Kindly permit me to move on.

Yes, please?

Government's initiatives to boost agriculture production and farmer's income

Mr Frank Afriyie on behalf of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (NDC — Keta): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the

Minister for Food and Agriculture what initiatives have been implemented to boost agricultural production and increase farmers' income.

Minister for Food and Agriculture (Mr Eric Opoku) (MP): Mr Speaker, the Ministry is rolling out the Feed Ghana Programme, a strategic initiative made up of nine sub-programmes. The programme aims to boost the productivity and production of 22 priority commodities through targeted interventions; including enhancing access to improved agricultural inputs (fertiliser, seeds, agrochemicals etc) expanded irrigation, mechanisation and land, improved market access, and enhanced agricultural financing. These measures are directly to increase efficiency in output and raise farm incomes across the 22 key value chains.

Mr Speaker, the nine sub-programmes and 22 priority commodities under the Feed Ghana Programme includes:

Sub-programmes

- Crop development
- Livestock development
- Establishment of Farmers' Services Centres (FSCs)
- Farm bank development
- Institutional farming
- Feed the industry (Tree Crops Development)

- Agro-production enclaves and irrigation for wealth
- Innovative agricultural financing
- Institutional development and management research

Mr Speaker, the 22 *priority commodities* also are:

- Grains and Legumes – Rice, Maize, Soybean and Sorghum
- Vegetables – Tomato, Pepper and Onion
- Starchy Crops – Cassava, Plantain and Yam
- Livestock – Poultry, Ruminants (Cattle, sheep, and goats), pigs
- Tree Crops – Mango, Shea, Cashew, Coconut and Oil palm

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much. I wish to thank the Hon Minister. Honestly, I can say on authority that farmers in my community have given testimonies about the fact that their lives are improving out of bumper harvest.

Strengthening extension services on best practices

Mr Frank Afriyie on behalf of Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey (NDC — Keta): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the

Minister for Food and Agriculture how the Government is strengthening extension services to provide farmers with information on best practices.

Minister for Food and Agriculture (Mr Eric Opoku) (MP): Mr Speaker, the Government is implementing a range of measures to strengthen agricultural extension and advisory to provide farmers with timely, practical, and relevant information on best practices. These include the following:

1. Farm and home visits:

Agricultural Extension Agents are deployed nationwide to undertake weekly farm and home visits and attend to the needs of farmers. Apart from the public extension agents, the ministry is working with the National Service Secretariat to recruit 10,000 personnel to support extension service delivery. So far about 2,097 National Service personnel and 300 feed Ghana Brigade personnel were deployed across the country. Working logistics such as motorbikes were recently distributed to 150 AEAs, and Feed Ghana Coordinators to enhance mobility and field work. Additional 410 motorbikes are programmed for distributed by close of the year. There are also continuous professional development programmes for AEAs to enhance extension and advisory services delivery. The areas of capacity development are agribusiness, farm management, value chain analysis, financial management, network and negotiations, group dynamics and leadership.

2. Agricultural Extension and Advisory Services Bill:

The Ministry is formulating the Agricultural Extension and Advisory Services Bill to regulate the professional practice of extension and advisory services. To this end the activities of both public and private extension service providers will be regulated. The Bill seeks to establish standards and guidelines for service delivery including the appropriate methods and approaches for disseminating improved technologies and information to farmers.

3:25 p.m.

With professionalised personnel both public and private, and well-regulated agricultural extension and advisory services space, farmers will be better served. Over 1,981 public extension agents, 2,285 community-based advisors, and a number of private sector extension providers are expected to be beneficiaries of the Bill.

Support for the Deployment of ICT to deliver extension services. To bridge the gap between farmers and Agricultural Extension Agents, ICT tools such as mobile phones, radio and other e-extension platforms have been deployed to complement the conventional AEA face-to-face interaction with farmers. Thirty-six episodes of weekly agricultural radio broadcasts in various local languages have been aired on topical issues across the regions and districts. In addition, six farmer friendly videos have been developed and translated into local languages for

dissemination and adoption. They cover topics such as deworming ruminants, selecting quality seeds, safe use and handling of agrochemicals, managing Newcastle disease in poultry, vegetable nursery bed establishment and proper housing for ruminants.

Strengthening Research, Extension and Farmer Linkages. Farmer constraints are addressed through close collaboration with research to provide information, innovation and improved technologies. These are in the form of community field demonstrations, trials, verification fields and provision of technical information on good agricultural practices to encourage adoption of improved technologies and innovations. Fifty-six community field demonstration plots on maize, rice, soya and tomatoes have been established in the North East, Northern and Upper East, Ashanti and Bono Regions. Some of the disseminated technologies are improved seed varieties (drought tolerant), soil fertility enhancement techniques such as biochar and compost application, blended fertilizers fortified with micronutrients, integrated pest and disease management strategies using neem oil and sustainable agricultural mechanisation.

The Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, that would be all. I am exceedingly grateful to you.

The Speaker: We will now move on to the Question numbered 465. The Question stands in the name of Mr

Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong, Hon Member for Kwabre East. You may ask your Question now.

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I stand on Order 88 (3) with the permission and authority of the Member, Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong, to seek your permission to ask the Question on his behalf.

The Speaker: Permission granted. Please, you may do so.

Volatility of World Market Prices of Cashew and Impact on Farm Gate Prices and Exports

Nana Asafo-Adjei Ayeh *on behalf of Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong (NPP — Kwabre East):* I beg to ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what the Ministry intends to do to address the volatility of the world market prices of cashew and its impacts on farm gate prices and exports.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, while price volatility remains a complex issue influenced by global market forces, the Tree Crops Development Authority, acting within its legal mandate, is implementing a combination of pricing reforms, regulatory enforcement, market monitoring, and investment promotion initiatives aimed at stabilising the cashew market, protecting farmers, and promoting sustainable value addition. The overarching goal is to ensure that Ghanaian cashew farmers receive fair, predictable, and competitive prices, while the country secures long-term growth and resilience in the cashew value chain.

The Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I only seek to ask about the measures. Are we looking at some timelines for, for example, the price reforms that he is mentioning and the regulations?

Mr E. Opoku: The enforcement of the regulations has started already. Some two or three weeks ago, I was in the Kumasi Police Training School to inaugurate a task force dedicated to ensuring the enforcement of all the rules and regulations in that particular sector. So, we have already started. If the Hon Member has been monitoring development in the tree crops sub-sector, he would appreciate the fact that these measures are underway.

Mr Ayeh: I would humbly seek of the Minister to tell us the extent to which his stakeholders within this area are being engaged with regards to the measures he is mentioning.

Mr E. Opoku: Stakeholders in the agricultural space are fully engaged in every policy that we are implementing. In fact, on assumption of office, before we developed the Feed Ghana programme document, which guides the implementation of all the programmes we are running under the Feed Ghana programme, we invited a technical team to put together the document. After that, all the stakeholders were invited to validate the contents of the document for implementation. That is the extent of engagement that we have gone through. So, stakeholders are fully engaged, and

we still want to engage more if the opportunity comes. In fact, if it is realised that the Hon Member, being a citizen of this country and a member of this House, has something to offer for agricultural development, I am ever ready to engage him.

Mr Ayeh: Mr Speaker, I am grateful to the Minister for appearing before the House to respond to my Question. I believe his response will be in the public domain for discussion.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Hon Members, we would move on to the Question numbered 528.

Nana Agyei Baffour Awuah — *rose* —

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, do you want to ask a supplementary question?

Mr Baffour Awuah: Yes, please. Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister acknowledged that pricing of cashew was determined by the market forces. Nevertheless, he also enumerated steps that were being taken to ensure stability of pricing as far as the local market was concerned. I want to find out from the Minister how these measures would ensure the stability of prices, given that it is determined by world market forces.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, the Hon Colleague who posed this question to me happens to be my classmate from the Kwame Nkrumah University of Science

and Technology (KNUST). When I was the electoral commissioner, he approached me to support him to get one of the positions, which I declined—*[Laughter]*—But, Mr Speaker, on a more serious note—

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, thankfully, we have colleagues from KNUST here. Hon Stephen Amoah was there. I never stood for any position on KNUST campus. Mr Speaker, he was the Electoral Commissioner, and we used to engage in political debate at the foyer of the Social Sciences Faculty. But I never stood for any position. So that is not correct and if it can be expunged from the record—

3:35 p.m.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr E. Opoku: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I do not want to respond to it. *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, on the issue of price stability in the world market, there is little we can do to influence prices in the world market. That is why in my Answer, I indicated that we are looking at value addition. So, instead of exporting the raw cashew nuts to the market and not getting enough in the form of incomes, we are adding value to what is produced here in order to increase our incomes domestically. That is the only way we can approve poverty from our system.

So, to ask how we can influence world market price from Ghana means that they do not have a better appreciation of the conditions in the world market—

The Speaker: Hon Member, before we proceed—we cannot leave this issue hanging. Did you actually approach him to sponsor you to stand for any of the posts?

Mr Baffour Awuah: Mr Speaker, I never approached him. He knows that I never stood for any position. He is just—Even as Electoral Commissioner, what power did he have to give a position.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, I never said in the way that he contested for elections. But he consulted me and discussed with me. Because I declined to support him, he did not—*[Laughter]*—In fact, in his own statement, he stated that we used to debate. Please ask him what the issues we debated on were. My Brother, it is from the past, do not bring it here. *[Laughter]*

The Speaker: Hon Members, it is his word against his. We do not want to go into investigation by cross-examination. So, we would end it here. We move on to the Question numbered 528. The Question numbered 528 stands in the name of—Sorry, Mrs Elizabeth Ofosu-Adjare—

Mrs Elizabeth Ofosu-Adjare: Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, while we were talking about value addition and cashew, I want to respectfully bring to your attention that this year's Budget has provision for the construction of two cashew factories in the Bono and Bono East Regions.

The Speaker: Are you the Minister for Food and Agriculture?

Mrs Ofosu-Adjare: Mr Speaker, I am the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry and responsible for value addition to cashew.

The Speaker: Have you been asked any Question?

Mrs Ofosu-Adjare: Mr Speaker, this is very important information that I needed to bring to the attention on the Floor.

The Speaker: At the appropriate time, you can give us that information.

Mrs Ofosu-Adjare: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Speaker: Please, do not try to take advantage of Question time to give us your information.

Yes, we move on to the Question numbered 528. Hon Member for Hemang Lower Denkyira, Mr Lawrence Agyinsam, you may ask the Question now—*[Pause]*

Since the Hon Member is not available, we move on to the next Question. The Question numbered 530 which stands in the name of the Hon

Member for Odotobri, Mr Anthony Mmieh. Please, Hon Member, you may do so now.

Interventions to Ensure Fair and Equitable Distribution of Food Nationwide.

Mr Anthony Mmieh (NPP — Odotobri): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister Food and Agriculture what interventions the Ministry is undertaking to ensure fair and equitable distribution of food nationwide in the light of the increasing cost of foodstuff across the country especially in mining communities.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, for this year, the Ministry through the Feed Ghana Programme has provided nationwide support to smallholder farmers by supplying essential farm inputs, including improved seeds of tomato, rice and maize, as well as fertilisers to boost crop production.

Mr Speaker, for this year, the Ministry, through the Feed Ghana Programme, has provided nationwide support to smallholder farmers by supplying essential farm inputs, including improved seeds of tomato, rice, and maize, as well as fertilizers to boost crop production.

In addition to individual farmers, the Ministry extended input support to key institutions such as the National Service Authority, the Ghana Prisons Service and some farmer-based organisations to enhance their agricultural productivity.

Again, the National Buffer Stock is being strengthened to mop up excess food produce from the systems as part of the strategy to ensure all year-round food supply.

Regional Directors have also been placed on alert to inform the Ministry and Buffer Stock of any excess produce occurring in their region for immediate mop up action.

Mr Speaker, these interventions collectively promote fair and inclusive access to food across Ghana by enhancing productivity in underserved regions. By targeting all the agro-ecological zones, the Ministry ensures that food production is not concentrated in a few areas, reducing regional disparities in food availability.

Secondly, by supporting institutional farms; Farm inputs to the Prisons Service, National Service Authority, and other institutional bodies help stabilise food supply in public institutions and Government programmes like the School Feeding Programme, reducing pressure on local markets.

Mr Speaker, the impact of these interventions is reflected in Ghana's recent food inflation trends. According to the Ghana Statistical Service, food inflation dropped to 3.9 per cent in December 2025, down from 28.3 per cent in January, 2025 when the National Democratic Congress (NDC) Government took over. This decline suggests improved food supply and price stability, driven by increased domestic

production and reduced reliance on imports.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

The Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Mr Mmieh: Yes, Mr Speaker, just one supplementary question. Are there any mechanisms the Ministry has put in place to monitor and prevent price manipulation and exploitation by middlemen, particularly within mining communities? How is the Ministry collaborating with local authorities to stabilise food prices in these areas?

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister, this is a very important question.

Mr E Opoku: Mr Speaker, we appreciate the fact that food prices in the production enclave are low. But when it comes to the urban areas, when demand is very high, food prices are high. It is the imbalance that we are trying to resolve.

So, we are developing what we call the farmers' market, where we can bring the farmers to interface with the buyers and consumers directly, as a way of removing those middlemen, who exploit the system in their favour. It is something that we are working on.

We are creating what we call the farmers' market. When that is created, the farmers would be able to bring the foodstuff to the market, where the consumers will be available. That is why in the Budget, we saw that allocation had been made for the construction of 1,000

kilometres of roads under what we call the agricultural roads. Because if we are able to fix roads linking the production centres to the consumption centres, transportation will be very easy. Once we are able to overcome that, food prices will be stable for all of us.

Thank you very much.

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Member?

3:45 p.m.

Mr Mmieh: Mr Speaker, I am compelled to ask my last supplementary in view of the last answer that was given by the Hon Minister. So, if I may be permitted.

The Speaker: You are learning by experience because when you said that was your last supplementary, I almost asked if you knew the answer that the Hon Minister will give? Because that could trigger another supplementary question but here, we are now. You are permitted, because you have not exhausted your three supplementary questions.

Mr Mmieh: Mr Speaker, I am very grateful. Hon Minister, are you aware of the fact that when it comes to food pricing in Ghana today, most foodstuff are priced higher in mining communities as against the urban areas? In view of the fact that lands which originally were used for farming have all been turned into mining sites now, thereby limiting the amount of foodstuff that is produced in mining areas. Are you aware of that?

The Speaker: Hon Minister, are you aware?

Mr Opoku: Mr Speaker, I am not aware. But the current situation is this, if the Hon Member is not aware, as we speak today, we have maize, rice, beans in excess of our demand. Even in this Chamber today, Hon Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo just approached me. He alone has almost 1,000 bags of maize ready for market and he is not getting market. In fact, I have even been told—

Mr Speaker, what we are doing as Government is that we have provided resources to the National Food Buffer Stock to mop up the excess from the market and stall against emergencies and this is the first time in the history of our country that we are doing this. It was never done during their time. It never happened.

The Speaker: Hon Members, usually it is not advisable to ask a question, “Are you aware?” Because the answer can be, I am not aware or I am aware and that is the end. You cannot come back again and so you do not ask questions like, “are you aware?” You see, Hon Minister, you are aware—I am not asking you because we are all experiencing it. The size of *kenkey* has not changed; neither has the price. It is part of the food glut. It is part of the lower prices; He is aware. We are together in that. Well, if he denies, I would assess him.

Mr Opoku: Mr Speaker, I am not aware.

The Speaker: Exactly what I stated. You see, so I have assessed him and I have just made him to know that it is not advisable for people to ask questions like, “are you aware?” Because the answer will be, “I am not aware” or “I am aware” and that is the end of it. So please, I will give more people the chance.

Yes I give the opportunity to the young man behind Hon Jinapor?

He is not young?

Some Hon Members: Mr Speaker, he is not young. *[Laughter]*

The Speaker: Hon Member, can you share your age with us? *[Laughter]*

Mr Gideon Boako: Mr Speaker, thank you very much. Mr Speaker, I am Gideon Boako, the MP for Tano North constituency and of course, I am one of your sons and I am very young.

Mr Speaker, the Minister talks about farmer’s market concepts and the understanding I get from what the Minister says is that the problem we have with the production of food and its distribution now is the difficulty in getting the foodstuffs from the farm gate to the main market or the intermediate markets, that is, by the roadside. I beg to differ and to suggest that there is a bigger problem than the movement of foodstuffs from the farm gate to the market. As the Minister indicated, a colleague Member of Parliament has about 1,000 bags of maize that are not in demand. Similarly, if we move across the country, I can use my constituency as an

example, if we go to the Tano North constituency that the Minister is very much conversant with, there are communities like Nsuapim, Bomaa and all of those places, we will see a lot of foodstuffs by the roadside.

The Speaker: Hon Member, please, ask the question.

Mr Boako: The question I want to put to the Hon Minister is that what measures is he putting in place to ensure that in the era of lower food inflation, the demand for food will be enhanced such that the farmers will also be better off. As it stands, the farmers are not better off because they produce and the produce are not in demand. What measures is the Minister putting in place to ensure that food is in high demand despite having lower inflation?

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Opoku: Mr Speaker, my understanding of the question is that, how do we increase demand for food in the system? But the Hon Member knows that everybody has limited capacity in respect of how much food to eat. So, what we are looking at is the entire value chain, processing of the food. The first step is increasing production, which we have achieved. We have produced so much to the extent that prices are collapsing far below what is expected. So, what we are going to do is to develop the entire value chain, set up processing factories, add value, package them, and even export. That is the only thing we can do to increase demand. But the first thing we must all applaud is that we have

increased food production. Now, having done that, what is next? The next thing is to look at how we can add value and that is what we are looking at.

Mr Speaker, he also talked about food prices. That food inflation has come down, but still prices are high. How can that be possible? What is the meaning of food inflation there? When we had food inflation at 61 per cent, Ghana was listed among 10 countries in Africa with the highest food prices so why is he saying that today food inflation is 3.9 per cent and we are still complaining about food prices? Where?

The Speaker: Yes, Hon Samuel Abdulai Jinapor?

Mr Samuel A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, today, the Ghana Statistical Service (GSS) reported that food insecurity has gone up, and it has moved from 35.3 per cent in quarter one 2024 to 38.1 per cent in quarter two 2025.

3:52 p.m. — [HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER, MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE CHAIR]

3:55 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have the floor.

Mr S. A. Jinapor: Mr Speaker, I was laying the foundation for the question, and the point was that GSS today has reported that food insecurity has risen from 35.3 per cent in 2024 to 38.1 per cent last year. The Service has actually warned that 13 million Ghanaians risk hunger this year.

Mr Speaker, this report was released by GSS today. The Minister is telling us that we are self-sufficient when it comes to food security. The question is, Mr Speaker, in the light of these alarming statistics and data put out by GSS today, what assurances can the Minister give to this House in terms of dealing with the situation where 13 million Ghanaians do not slip into hunger?

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, I have already indicated that as we speak, we are building a food buffer. In fact, I will write to GSS to give us the locations of these individuals, so that from our buffer, we can supply them. I am not disputing what he has said. What I am saying is that, if we have 13 million people in Ghana who are food insecure, we must know their location so that we can make them food secure. Does he understand? That is why I am saying that once we have a food buffer against emergencies, the Hon Member should just indicate to me that close to his house, he has 10 people who are food insecure and I will supply them with food today.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Food and Agriculture is aware that GSS information is for the whole country. He has also said that there is enough food in the system, but people are not able to buy it. It is also public knowledge that the Bank of Ghana has siphoned off over GH¢60 billion from the markets, and this is not allowing traders to trade with the money. I therefore put it to him that

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have a right to ask a question, but not to put it to the Minister. Kindly resume your seat.

Hon Boamah-Nyarko, you have the floor.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the Minister, in his response, has continuously put on the floor of the House that the Ghana National Buffer Stock Company (GNBSC) is being strengthened to mop up excess food produced from the system as part of the strategy to ensure all year-round food supply. It is different when the buffer stock is being strengthened and it is different when it has been strengthened. Because when you go to the market—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, what is your question?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: I am building a point for just 30 seconds, then I will ask the question. I am saying this because this is a national concern. If you check around, there are a lot of complaints about food being produced at the site, and they are not being brought to the market. This is a major issue. My question is that if the GNBSC has been or is supposed to be strengthened, this year, how much has been released to GNBSC, and what have they been able to purchase out of the market so that we can be sure that they are buying the excesses from the market to give price stability to the traders, and also have enough stock to feed people.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, yes, he is right. He knows exactly what is happening in the system, which is far different from what other Colleagues have been saying. When we go to Sissala, the Hon Member's position is excellent. They have produced maize, rice, beans, and others far in excess of the demand in that area. As we speak, the price of a bag of maize in Sissala is selling around GHC250.00 to GHC300.00. If farmers are allowed to sell at this price, certainly, they cannot recoup their investment. That is why I am saying that we have resourced GNBSC. In the 2025 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, this House approved GHC100 million for them to mop up the excesses and that was insufficient. That was why in the 2026 Budget Statement and Economic Policy, an additional GHC200 million was provided. And I added that this is the first time in the history of our country that Ghana is building a food buffer against emergencies. The Hon Member does not know the story so he should not shout. That is the reality and he cannot contest this. The Hon Member should ask his Colleagues.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, address the Chair.

Ms Patricia Appiagyei — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Deputy Minority Leader?

Ms Patricia Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, I would like to appeal to you with regard to our Hon Member of Parliament for Takoradi. He is a very Senior person in

this Chamber, and I want to appeal to you to allow him to rephrase —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You would agree with me that Question time is not a period for cross-examination. It is not a period for making Statements. Above all, he is asking a supplementary question; go ahead and ask your question. After a long background, he said I am putting it to you. Are we doing cross-examination? So, you have rightly stated that he is a senior Member, and he knows exactly that Question time is not a time for cross-examination. That was my worry.

Ms Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, I am only pleading with you that you give him the opportunity to rephrase the question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

You have the floor; rephrase your question.

Mr Darko-Mensah: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

This question is very important, which is why I have risen to ask again.

Mr Speaker, the fact of the matter is that there is food insecurity across the length and breadth of the country. The Minister is also saying that there are lots of food across the country that has not been bought from farmers. My question is that if the Bank of Ghana has siphoned so much money out of the system and the Minister is saying that there is overproduction, I would like to know

from the Minister how much in value terms of food that are still sitting at the farmers' gates, and how much of the GH¢200 million that they have budgeted for will be able to take away from the farmers so that the farmers can work this year.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, according to our technical team, we need not less than GH¢600 million to be able to mop up the excess of food that we have in our system now, especially paddy rice.

4:05 p.m.

I am surprised that even in Minority, they cannot speak with one voice. An Hon Colleague just got up here and said there is food everywhere but they are not getting market. Another person would get up here and say he has not seen that there is food, and that there is food insecurity. Why can you not adopt a common position?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the Minister in answering the question, used a certain phrase, which I think is not right and that he should withdraw it. He said even in Minority, we cannot even agree. Mr Speaker, when he says that, he is generating—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: He said you are not speaking with one voice.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, his answer must not generate debate, so

with respect to the Hon Minister, this is not his political platform. I beg of him to withdraw it, or else—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, when I took over, I gave the floor to Hon Boamah-Nyarko and his question resulted in an answer from the Hon Minister that “I agree with you; if you go to Sissala, that is what is actually happening”. Now, Hon Darko-Mensah also came in. So, is it not the case that when you juxtapose Hon Darko-Mensah's question as against Hon Boamah-Nyarko's question, what the Hon Minister is saying is correct?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, how can individual members' question be the position of the Minority? He said that even in Minority, we are not agreeing. It is not the Minority speaking, Mr Speaker, so he must withdraw that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, should I give the Hon Minister the opportunity to say “Minority Members”?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: No, Mr Speaker, if an Hon Member asks a question in his capacity, you do not attribute it to the entire Minority.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Habib, should I give the floor to the Minister to correct it by saying “Minority Members”?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: He should put it in proper perspective, because what he said—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That “Minority Members”?

Hon Minister, they said you should put it in proper perspective.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, what I said was very simple. I thought this is the Minority, and in fact, they described themselves as “the Mighty Minority”. Then a Colleague from the Minority said—*[Interruption]*—No, if they want me to address the cocoa matter, I want to assure them, even though it is not under me, if I am given the opportunity, I will deal with it here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, the issue is not about cocoa, so, ignore the side comments.

Mr E. Opoku: What I said was a fact. But if they want to be considered as individuals, and no longer the “Mighty Minority” they claim to be, then I will withdraw that common position, and say that I cannot understand why Members of this House can have such different opinions on matters that are common to everybody in this country. But in any case, if in your constituency the people are food insecure, then there is something that you must know. At the beginning of 2025, as part of the Feed Ghana programme, we launched a campaign for individual households to have backyard gardens, so that on their own, they can produce some vegetables to support the feeding of the house. This was a strategic move to reduce the cost of feeding in this country. Many people participated. I do not think you can say on this Floor, that you and your constituents never participated in this programme.

Then again, we also advocated for secondary schools to have school farms, and 413 schools have been registered. They have been given inputs and they are producing to support the School Feeding Programme. This will obviously reduce total demand on the system. Churches are participating, state agencies are participating, Members of Parliament are also participating. As we speak, the Hon former Minister for Defence signaled me that he also has 2,000 bags of rice and he is looking for market. Then a Colleague just to his left is talking about food insecurity. That is why I said that, look, if people are food insecure, let me know where they are. If they are in your constituency, I will just buy the rice from Hon Nitiwul, and then sell to them immediately. That solves the problem, so we do not have to have a banter over this matter.

Mr Nitiwul — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Dominic Nitiwul?

Mr Dominic Bingab Aduna Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, thank you very much. It is actually true that I have 2,000 100kg bags of paddy rice.

Mr Speaker, the reason is that last year around this period, that same bag of rice was GHC1,000. Today, it is being sold at GHC400. So, the problem is not over-production. Mr Speaker, if you go to Chamba Market, Binduri Market, Techiman Market, Kpasa Market, when the farmers take their yam, cassava, maize, *et cetera* there, people are not buying, and they have to carry it back.

His Hon Colleagues are spread across the whole country, and can testify to it.

So, Mr Speaker—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Nitiwul, what is your question?

Mr Nitiwul: Mr Speaker, my question to the Hon Minister is, what steps would he take to solve this very problem? When farmers take their produce to the market, people do not buy them and they would have to take it back home and return them to the market the following week. Whether it is tubers, rice, maize, pepper or dried okra, people are not buying.

How would he make sure that that problem is resolved for farmers? That is what farmers want to hear. That is all it is.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Minister, though you provided the answer in a way, you may have the floor.

Mr E. Opoku: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

I think I have answered this question earlier when the same question was posed by Hon Samuel Jinapor. I said, what we are looking at is value addition. That is why we have launched the Feed the Industry programme, and it is being handled by the Minister for Trade, Agribusiness and Industry. *[Interruption]* They are saying now. You see—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon former Minister, listen to the answer first.

Mr E. Opoku: I like the spirit with which he is asking that it should be done now. I am worried that he did not have the same spirit when you had the power to do so because all these things were there. They never did it. Today we are doing it. We are adding value and he is saying it should be done now. As we speak, we have registered some of the millers in the northern enclave, where we have the glut of paddy rice. What we want them to do is to buy the paddy rice, mill it, and then transport to the Buffer Stock Company to buy them. We have also spoken to ECOWAS. This time around, we are not going to borrow rice. We are not going to borrow maize. Rather, we are asking them to come and buy from us here.

So, we are putting in place a lot of mechanisms, and I am giving the Hon former Minister for Defence the assurance that his 2,000 bags of paddy rice that he is complaining about, the Ministry of Food and Agriculture, through the Buffer Stock Company, will buy them. That is why I am worried about our Hon Colleagues, who in spite of this situation, are saying that there is food insecurity. Is it because they are living in a different world or what? That is the problem I have because the Hon former Minister for Defence knows the reality, his Hon Colleague does not know the reality, and he is talking about something that is not in existence. That is the difficulty.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Habib Iddrisu?

4:15 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if I heard the Minister right, he said that until this year, there had never been any food security buffers. The then Prof Mills' Administration established the Buffer Stock for two main reasons. One, for commercial purposes and two, to get a food buffer for food security in terms of a crisis. So, is he saying that from then up to today, there has never been any food or buffers for purposes of food security? Is that the case?

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, that is exactly my point.

An amount of GHC12 million was given to the Buffer Stock to set up during Prof Mills' Administration. Since then, the Government of Ghana has never advanced a pesewa to the Buffer Stock to maintain strategic stocks for emergencies until 2025 and 2026. These are facts that can be verified. He is aware; he is a Member of the Committee. He knows this.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, is it the case that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib Iddrisu, how many supplementary questions are you entitled to? By the rules, how many supplementary questions are you entitled to? Hon Habib Iddrisu, once you have exceeded your supplementary question, I think—How many are you entitled to?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, all right, my last question.

So, based on the Answer provided, is the Minister saying that there was no proper thinking by the Prof Mills' Administration in establishing the National Food Buffer Stock Company?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, so long as you said “no proper thinking”, I have not heard that from the Minister, so I will disallow the question. Minister, resume your seat.

Yes, Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib, you have the floor.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

I want to respectfully ask the Minister what it means to say that there is food insecurity against the backdrop that the yam farmers are complaining that they have a lot of harvest, as well as the rice farmers. Is it the inability to procure them that constitutes food insecurity, or their accessibility? I would respectfully want the Minister— because he was trying to let my Senior know that we do not understand food insecurity, so we want him to shed more light on it.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, food security means food must be available; it must be affordable, and the food must be in its right combination. Let us say we are talking about a balanced diet. We mean to get the nutrients in the right proportion, and the supply must be sustainable. There should be no means to have a shortage of food in the system.

When we have sufficient food, we cannot complain about it.

Then we talk about whether people can afford it, and I say yes, because food prices have collapsed so low. That is why I said as a nation, we are building food buffers. If they say that they have conducted a survey and the findings are that some people are food insecure, they should indicate to us the locations so that we can go to our stores, make food available to them, so they will be fed. That is all.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I have videos of farmers complaining with reference to the tubers of yams they have, bags of rice and all of that. If the Minister has not seen those videos, I will share them with him so that he can see what they are complaining about.

In fact, some are dying, saying that they are unable to pay their children's school fees.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Shaib, you are engaging in arguments rather than asking questions.

Mr Shaib: Very well, Mr Speaker, that is all.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, what the Hon Member is saying is not even relevant. He is talking about videos of farmers complaining that they are not getting a market for their produce. That is exactly what I am saying here. And we are saying that, because of that, we have empowered National Food Buffer Stock Company to enter the market and mop up

the excess. So, the pictures will never portray insecurity of food anywhere. That is why I said that it is irrelevant. He did not even need to point to those things.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we take the last supplementary question, then we move on. I have been taking from the left Side. Let me take one supplementary from Hon Norgbey. Hon Kingsley Nyarko, resume your seat for now.

Dr Ernest Henry Norgbey: Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture if it is true that in a few years past, a bag of rice was GH¢1000, but has now reduced to GH¢400?

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, yes, it is true. In 2024, a 100kg bag of rice was sold at GH¢1600. Even maize was sold at GH¢1,600. Today, it is around GH¢300 and GH¢400 in other areas. The Hon Member mentioned Techiman market. Just last week, we sent our team there to buy maize. It was around GH¢500. When one goes to Ejura, the farmers are crying because they are not getting the prices they want. That is the situation. In the face of abundance, certainly, prices will collapse.

But we have to put in place mechanisms to protect the interests and investment of these farmers. And that is why I disagree with the doomsayers when they talk about food insecurity and the rest of them in Ghana.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I would like to ask the Minister about national support for smallholder farmers. The criteria that were used in the nationwide support, the regional composition, and the costs involved in this whole exercise.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, having regard to the Question on the Floor, you may kindly file a new Question. Thank you very much.

Hon Members, let us move to the Question numbered 529, also standing in the name of Hon Anthony Mmieh, Member of Parliament for Odotobri.

You have the floor.

Measures to Enhance the Oil Palm Industry in Ghana

Mr Anthony Mmieh (NPP — Odotobri): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture what specific measures are currently being implemented to enhance the oil palm industry in Ghana, particularly in the processing sector, given that the Minerals Commission has distributed millions of oil palm seedlings since 2019.

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, the Tree Crops Development Authority (TCDA) is recognised as the sole authority mandated to regulate and develop the mandated crops, including the oil palm. The TCDA, in conjunction with the Oil

Palm Research Institute (OPRI) and the Oil Palm Development Association of Ghana, coordinates the distribution of oil palm seedlings to farmers. The OPRI is supported to focus on research into improved varieties of seeds and seedling production.

4:25 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the objectives of the Government of Ghana's Integrated Oil Palm Development Policy include cultivating 100,000 hectares of new oil palm plantations, creating over 250,000 direct and indirect jobs across the value chain, achieving self-sufficiency in palm oil production and export competitiveness, promoting sustainability, gender inclusion, and equitable participation for women and youth.

Mr Speaker, under the supply of oil palm seedlings to farmers initiative, the Tree Crop Development Authority has distributed over 2 million oil palm seedlings to farmers. A Seed and Seedling Production Policy has been developed by TCDA, the Oil Palm Development Association of Ghana, and the Oil Palm Research Institute of the Council for Science and Industrial Research to regulate that part of the value chain. The OPRI and the Ghana Standards Authority have developed standards and guidelines for seed production and distribution, which will regulate the operation of nurseries and traders of seedlings.

Mr Speaker, on processing, as part of the Government's US\$500 million investment in the oil palm sector, as

stated in the 2026 Budget Statement, the World Bank is examining data from the top large-scale processes to determine financing structure and models for investment into the Sector.

And again, equal attention is being paid to the small-scale artisanal processes to provide modern and efficient machinery that is environmentally friendly. The Sector employs nearly 60,000 people, mostly women and youth.

Mr Speaker, though TCDA is not involved in the distribution of seedlings by the Minerals Commission, the Ministry will not hesitate to respond to a request from the Minerals Commission.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Mmieh: Mr Speaker, there will be no supplementary questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we will move to the Question numbered 659, standing in the name of Hon Dr Thomas Anabah, Member of Parliament for Garu.

Status of the Stalled Tamne Irrigation Project

Dr Thomas Winsum Anabah (NDC — Garu): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Food and Agriculture the status of the stalled Tamne Irrigation Project in Garu, the steps the Ministry is implementing to ensure its completion, and when it is expected to be completed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, the Tamne phase 3 project combines outstanding works from phases 1 and 2, along with infrastructure that was damaged after the completion during the 2021 Northern Ghana floods. The scope of phase 3 of the project includes downstream works, conduit works, spillway channel stablisation works, spillway dike formation, canal construction, and irrigable area development. All the physical works under phase 3 are about 70 per cent complete. The outstanding works to date include the construction of lateral canals, the installation of terminal gates, and the clearing of approximately 300 hectares of farmland.

Mr Speaker, the challenge is that the resurgence of the age-old chieftaincy conflict between the Mamprusis and the Kusasis within the Bawku Garu enclave, where the project is situated, has unfortunately affected the smooth execution and completion of the project. The contractor had to move his staff out of the project site when it became unsafe and dangerous to continue operations. As it stands, the project completion timeline is in suspense due to the conflict situation.

Mr Speaker, the project management team and the contractor are currently monitoring the situation on the ground and will proceed to finish the work when the conditions become favourable. The Ministry of Food and Agriculture, through the District Department of

Agriculture for the four district assemblies, will continue to support farmers in expanding their operations in irrigable areas. The Ghana Irrigation Development Authority will continue to educate landowners and mobilise farmers for the effective management of their irrigation schemes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Dr Anabah: Mr Speaker, a follow-up question. They say the devil always finds work for idle hands. The youth are engaged perhaps in the conflict because they have no work to do.

So, Mr Speaker, considering the quantum of work that has been done already just to devolve the irrigable part of the land behind the dike, would it not be worth it to deploy security to protect the contractor so that he would conclude the little job that is left to make the place irrigable and to employ the very youth who are engaged in the conflict, because we have spent a lot of money already —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, you have asked your question.

Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr E. Opoku: Mr Speaker, I think that is a good suggestion, but we are also looking at it from this perspective. Talking to the youth to bring an end to the conflict so that we can create a congenial environment and then enliven it, which can develop the area. So, that is what we are working on.

Mr Speaker, let me say that the Hon Member who posed this Question has been to my office more than 10 times on this particular project. At some point, I even had to invite the contractor and the project management team to come and meet with him to see how we can find a lasting solution to the situation, but it all boils down to the insecurity in the area. We are also working with the security agencies, especially the Police. As soon as they give us an indication that the place is safe for construction to begin, I can promise my Hon Colleague that we will not hesitate to move to the field.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further supplementary?

Dr Anabah: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. We will collaborate with him and speak to the youth to lay down their arms and allow the contractor to come back.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is a constituency-specific Question.

Hon Minister, we thank you so much for attending upon the House to respond to a number of Questions slated for you.

You are hereby discharged.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I want to plead with you to truncate the Business time on Questions and pray that we do a Committee of the Whole so that we can take the National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) formula because the Hon Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment has had an

emergency call in the office, so he is not immediately available to deal with the three Questions standing in his name.

So, I want to use the opportunity to pray you to do a Committee of the Whole and take the formula on NHIS and the Medical Trust Fund. Then we can come back and continue.

4:35 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Deputy Minority Leader?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I wish to live long. The application mounted by the Majority Chief Whip finds favour with us, because we have had an engagement to that effect. We do not object to it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, that being the sense of the House, I would then reconstitute the House into a Committee of the Whole. While reconstituting the House into a Committee of the Whole, I will invite the Hon Minister for Health as well as the officials from the National Health Insurance Authority to take their designated seat.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let the record reflect that we are also considering the Ghana Medical Trust Fund formula as well as the NHIS formula.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, do not lead me into temptation. My

instruction is to do the National Health Insurance Scheme. That is the instruction that I have received.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I am certain that you will receive further instruction —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Should I receive a further instruction, we will do so.

The House is accordingly constituted into a Committee of the Whole.

4:34 p.m. — *[The House was constituted into a Committee of the Whole.]*

5:40 p.m. — *Sitting resumed.*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, kindly resume your seat. The House is constituted into Plenary.

Yes, Majority Leader, any indication?

Mr Ayariga: We will take the Questions. Item numbered 8.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, we go back to the item numbered 8 — Questions. We are starting from Question numbered 470. The Minister for Labour, Job and Employment should take the designated seat as I call on Hon Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo, Member of Parliament for Manso Nkwanta, to have the floor and pose the Question numbered 470. Hon Minister, you are welcome.

Mr John Darko: Mr Speaker, with respect, I come under the remit of Order

88 (3) and seek your indulgence to ask the Question standing in the name of Hon Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have the floor.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF LABOUR, JOBS AND EMPLOYMENT

Measures Taken on Labour Upheavals

Mr John Darko on behalf of Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (NPP — Manso Nkwanta): I beg to ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what proactive measures the Ministry is taking on labour upheavals that has become rife lately in the country.

Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment (Dr Abdul-Rashid Hassan Pelpuo): Mr Speaker, labour concerns we are addressing today have been a carryover of issues that had not been fully addressed in the past which we are committed to tackle right away.

Measures being taken include;

- a) Monitoring Early Warning Signals;
- b) Improving surveillance activities;
- c) Deepening social dialogue with Labour Unions; and
- d) Facilitating the implementation of Memoranda of Understanding/Agreement between Government and Labour Unions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Darko: By early warning signal, I want to find out whether the Hon Minister has detected the Colleges of Education Teachers Association of Ghana (CETAG) strike and what has he done about it?

Dr Pelpuo: We detected it earlier and we were wishing that they would come forward for fuller negotiation, until a point when they believe a strike action was going to be the solution to the problem. But in the course of the dialogue, they slipped into the strike, so we are still working on it. It is something we are so concerned about and are committed to solving the problems that pose as a challenge to them.

Mr Darko: I want to find out from the Hon Minister whether he has any indication, especially having engaged CETAG, on when the strike will come to an end?

Dr Pelpuo: Mr Speaker, two days ago, I invited Labour Commission to my office, and we had a long discussion. They told me the efforts they have made and the commitment by leadership of CETAG to go along with them. But I also heard the Minister for Education promising to fulfil the demands made by CETAG.

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, with respect, my last follow-up question on that. One of the things CETAG is asking for is salary arrears. Is the Minister aware of that? How much money is involved to clear the salary arrears?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, to know the actual amount involved in salary arrears, you may have to file a fresh Question so that the Minister can prepare to give you the exact amount involved. Let us avoid elements of surprises. That brings you to the end of your follow-up question.

In the absence of any follow-up, we move to the Question numbered 503, also standing in the name of Hon Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo, Member of Parliament for Manso Nkwanta.

Tracking of Employment Growth

Mr John Darko on behalf of Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (NPP — Manso Nkwanta): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what the Ministry is using to track employment growth and if these targets area being met.

Dr Pelpuo: Mr Speaker, the Ministry is collaborating with the Ghana Statistical Service to develop a mechanism for tracking employment growth and targets in the country.

This mechanism is expected to regularise the production of quarterly employment and unemployment data to better track labour market trends, job creation, and youth unemployment rates.

Additionally, Government is in the process of establishing a National Employment Coordination Commission that would be responsible for setting national and sectoral employment targets for the productive sectors to track

employment growths and undertake employment impact assessments of Government's investments.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Darko: Yes, Mr Speaker.

From the Hon Minister's Answer, he suggests that there is a National Employment Coordination Commission being established. Is it to say that the Ghana Statistical Service is unable to give us accurate information for which reason you are setting up this National Employment Coordination Commission?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Dr Pelpuo: The Ghana Statistical Service has an overall functional duty of working with the statistics across the board. But employment issues are specific issues dealing with job creation and absorption of the unemployed in Ghana. This is a huge area and cannot be a subset to the bigger issue done by the Ghana Statistical Service. So, we want to focus directly on employment and give it a leverage, so that at any point in time we can ask and it will be given. But it does not mean that the Ghana Statistical Service will not be working on employment, but it will not be that detailed as when a commission is set up for that.

Mr Darko: The Hon Minister said that he is in the process of setting up the Commission. So, is he able to give this House and the people of Ghana an

update? What is the status of the setting up of the Commission? If you can give timelines, what are the timelines for the completion of this set up?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Right now, we are on the drawing board. It is a policy area, and the policy is taking shape. It is going to result in a legal regime that will set it up, then I will be able to state specifically what the timelines are.

Mr Isaac Boamah-Nyarko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I take notice of the Minister's response with regard to the Ministry's collaboration with the Ghana Statistical Service to develop a mechanism for tracking employment growth and targets.

5:50 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I want the Minister to give us some understanding as to the nature of the collaboration, because when it comes to data on employment growth and tracking, it is very key—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, your question is asked. Minister, tell the House the nature of the collaboration.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Second—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You are to ask one question at a time. Look at the rules.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, he can proceed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, Minister, what is the nature of the collaboration?

Dr Pelpuo: Under the Executive Instrument (E.I.) by the President, the Ghana Statistical Service (GSS) is working directly under my supervision. So, the collaboration is a necessary system of working together to achieve that objective. I am actually asking them to do it from my position as the Minister in charge.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I do not think I clearly got the nature of collaboration from the Minister's response.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, it is not the answer you want. It is the answer that the Minister wants to give.

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: All right. In line with that, I want to seek from the Minister the mechanism that is supposed to be developed. Can he give this House an idea as to when that mechanism will be developed, so that we, as a Parliament, can also track?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, the Minister, in his answer, indicated that he would not be able to speak regarding timelines and that the legislative regimes would come to the Floor —

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, that was in relation to the establishment of a coordinating Commission. That was what he could not determine the timeline for its establishment. But this question is in relation to—He said that since GSS works under his Ministry, they are in constant collaboration. He is talking about the development of mechanisms to track employment growth. What I am

asking the Minister is that, since the Ministry is leading the collaboration, when would that mechanism be developed, so that this House can also follow through with him in due course to track it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minister, will you be able to give the timeline?

Dr Pelpuo: Mr Speaker, as a Minister, I am a policymaker. I am not an implementer of policy. The GSS is going to implement that policy. So, if he wants the details on how they are doing it, he may like to pose a Question. Then I will get them to come and give him the details.

Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe: Mr Speaker, I would like to ask the Minister, prior to the collaboration with GSS, was the Ministry having any project in place?

Dr Pelpuo: Yes, I was saying that the other project in place is the fact that we are asking them to help develop the National Commission on Employment. So, it is part of the efforts we are working on. But as in projects, we are asking them to do something visible for anyone to see, I do not think we have that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we now move to the Question numbered 504.

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You have the floor.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, in the Hon Minister's earlier response in reference to the Question numbered 503, he talked about employment growth and what the Government has done over the period. I am just wondering if, as part of employment growth, we could consider those employees whose appointments were revoked on 17th February, exactly a year today, and what we are doing about those who have not been recalled? Because there were some who were beyond the date that was given in the Chief of Staff's Directive. Some were employed way before 7th December, but their employment was also terminated. As you talked about employment growth—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon available Leader, once your question is specific, file it. The Minister will prepare to come and answer.

Mr Shaib: Very well, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will move to Question number 504, also standing in the name of Hon Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo, Member of Parliament for Manso Nkwanta. By extension, you have the leave to ask the Question.

Measures to Strengthen Occupational Health and Safety Standards in High-Risk Industries

Mr John Darko on behalf of Mr Tweneboa Kodua Fokuo (NPP — Manso Nkwanta): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Labour, Jobs and Employment what is being done to improve occupational health and safety

standards, especially in high-risk industries like construction and mining.

Dr Abdul-Rashid H. Pelpuo: Mr Speaker, the Ministry through the Department of Factories Inspectorate undertakes regular inspection of all workplaces including high-risk industries like construction and mining to promote occupational safety and health standards.

In addition, a Special Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) Task Force has been inaugurated to augment the work of the Department of Factories Inspectorate. Since its inauguration, the Task Force has improved compliance and enforcement of occupational safety and health standards in all sectors

The Ministry reiterates its commitment to enforcing occupational safety and health standards in high-risk industries including construction and mining to avert occupational accidents and injuries.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, yes.

Would the Minister not rather retool the Department of Factories and Inspectorate to undertake this job rather than setting up a task force, which is a temporary project? Would he do that just to save the people of Ghana? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, I consider that to be a suggestion rather than a question.

Mr Darko: Let me rephrase this, Mr Speaker.

Does the Minister not think that retooling and supporting the Department of Factories and Inspectorate is far better than setting up a task force to do this job?

Dr Pelpuo: Mr Speaker, I think so. I agree with him. If we were capable of retooling, equipping, and giving them the needed vents, power, and capacity, it would be better for us than to set up a task force. But in the absence of that, and in the absence of the level of commitment and work we want them to do, the alternative is to get a task force to do what they should be doing. Remember, this is just a small office, but a small office should provide people to go around the whole country, inspect all the factories, offices, and make sure they do the right thing.

That office, I do not think it is up to 50 individuals who are in that office. It is a very small office. So, in order to reach the scale that we want, the best alternative is to do a task force to get the work done.

6:00 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further supplementary question?

Mr Darko: Yes, Mr Speaker. Since the Hon Minister agrees with me that it is better to retool than to set up a task force, is he able to tell the people of Ghana what is preventing them from retooling rather than setting up a task

force, because they are going to spend money on the task force anyway?

Dr Pelpuo: I want to remind Hon Member that this is a Civil Service Organisation. It requires an increased number of workers; it requires increased construction of physical equipment; it involves provision of vehicles. It is such a huge investment. I believe that over the years, it has not been done by governments because the investment is huge. But this is what we are now going to tackle. In order to do what others have not done, we want to set up a task force, provide them with the necessary financial capacity, and we will do the necessary thing that should be done.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon John Darko?

Mr Darko: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

The Hon Minister said they have integrated it, so they are in place, is that not it? Is the task force now doing the work of the Inspectorate Department?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Dr Pelpuo: The task force is supplementary. It simply means that we want to help the Inspectorate Division to reach its objective. So, it has not taken over the leadership of the Inspectorate. It is simply adding on the needed force to what they have. You do not have the leader of the task force being the one signing agreements, or to whom letters are addressed. The Inspectorate Division

is still having its leadership in place, appointed by the Head of Civil Service. They still run. So, the task force takes instructions from them and then works to supplement what they have not been able to do.

Thank you.

Mr Darko — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Darko, you have exhausted your supplementary question.

Mr Darko: Yes, Mr Speaker, I just to thank the Hon Minister for answering the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Minister, thank you.

Yes, Hon Member for Suhum?

Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

One of the banes of the Factories Inspectorate Office is inadequate human capital. I want the Hon Minister to tell us what specifically he has done to ensure that they are resourced.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you can file a specific Question on how they are being resourced.

Mr Bekoe: Mr Speaker, because he has answered a question on that, so this is a follow-up.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: He just said it is a supplementary. So, if you want to know how they are being resourced, in

terms of resources, file a fresh Question. If you do not have any other supplementary question, kindly resume your seat.

Hon Members, on your behalf, I want to thank the Minister for Labour, Job and Employment for attending upon the House to respond to the questions scheduled for him for today. Hon Minister, thank you very much. You are accordingly discharged.

Hon Members, that brings us to the end of Question time.

Yes, Majority Leader, any indication?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we intend to take the Reports on the two formulas so, my prayer is that we go back to the item numbered 7 to take a couple of Statements, so that when the Reports are ready, we can come back and take them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Second Minority Whip?

Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib: Mr Speaker, I was hoping he would engage, but he did not. I do not know if he is behind the arrest of Baba Jamal, but if he is not, we are minded to proceed.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, Baba Jamal has not been arrested, so why would my Brother bring this matter to the Floor? There is no indication. My Brother, Baba Jamal, is not under arrest. He is a free man. He is campaigning hard.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the application is to take the item numbered 7. This completely has nothing to do with arrest. So, the only issue is, are you acceding to the application, or not? Arrest is an extraneous matter.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, we are not opposed to the application.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. We then move to the item numbered 7, Statements.

The first Statement stands in the name of Hon Dr Abed-Nego Lamangin Bandim, Member of Parliament for Bunkpurugu, to make a Statement on the Security Situation and Reported disappearances in Nakpanduri. Hon Member, you have the floor.

STATEMENT

Security Situation and Reported Disappearances in Nakpanduri

Dr Abed-Nego Lamangin Bandim (NDC — Bunkpurugu): Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, I rise to bring to the urgent attention of this House a persistent security challenge that threatens the stability of the Bunkurugu enclave in the North East region. I refer to the recurring pattern of unexplained disappearance within the “Muog” territory, a situation that requires immediate state intervention.

Mr Speaker, on Sunday 25th January, 2026, community stakeholders and the National Association of Bimoba, Moba and Gurma (NABMAG) reported the disappearance of yet another citizen in Nakpanduri. This recent incident is not an isolated event, but part of a documented trajectory. Records indicate that about seven people have been missing since 2001 to 2026, at least, seven individuals from Nakpanduri and its environs have been reported missing and remain unaccounted for.

Mr Speaker, the absence of conclusive investigations into these cases has created a climate of uncertainty. For the families involved, the lack of closure is a source of profound distress. For the broader community, it fuels suspicion and strains social cohesion necessary for peace and development.

Mr Speaker, the latest disappearance must be viewed within the context of recent deterioration of the security environment in the North East Region. We note with concern that just ten days prior to mid-January 2026, police barriers in the Nalerigu and Gambaga areas were set ablaze by unknown persons. Such attacks on security infrastructure suggest a growing boldness among criminal elements that compromises the safety of constituents.

Furthermore, the topography of Nakpanduri, especially the Scarp, presents unique security challenges. Intelligence assessments have long indicated that the difficult terrain can be exploited by transnational criminal networks, and extremist element seeking

sanctuary. It is imperative that our security architecture adapts to effectively police the geography.

6:10 p.m.

Mr Speaker, Article 13 of the 1992 Constitution guarantees the protection of life and personal liberties. The unresolved nature of these disappearances suggests a gap in our enforcement of these guarantees. Routine procedures have proven insufficient. A more rigorous intelligence-led approach is required. In light of this, I make the specific demands.

Mr Speaker, I call upon the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice (CHRAJ) to exercise its mandate under the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice Act, 1993 Act 456 to conduct a preliminary investigation into these seven cases. We require an independent assessment to determine if there has been a systemic failure in the State's duty to protect its citizens. To the police administration: while we acknowledge the logistical constraints facing the Service, the current situation demands specialised attention. I urge the Inspector General of Police to deploy a dedicated team, potentially the Cold Case Unit, to the North East Region to review the dockets of these missing persons. The families deserve definitive answers.

To the National Commission on Civic Education (NCCE), leveraging the NORPREVSEC (Preventing Electoral

Violence and Providing Security to the Northern Border Regions of Ghana) project, I charge the Commission to intensify security awareness in the Bunkpurugu-Nakpanduri District. It is vital that our citizens are empowered to report suspicious activities in a timely and fear-free manner.

Mr Speaker, I appeal to our traditional authorities and the leadership of the National Association of Bimobas, Mobas and Gurmas (NABMAG) to support the State's efforts. As custodians of the land, your collaboration is essential in identifying and rooting out the internal actors who may be facilitating these crimes. The people of Nakpanduri and the North East Region look to the House and the State for assurance. We cannot allow a part of this country to become a zone of silence where citizens vanish without explanations.

I urge this House to support the call for a thorough investigation and a robust security response to these matters.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to make this Statement. Thank you. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that is the Statement on the security situation at Nakpanduri. The floor is now open for comment on the statement.

Yes, Hon Peter Toobu Lanchene, you have the floor.

Supt Rtd Peter Lanchene Toobu (NDC — Wa West): Mr Speaker, thank you so much for the opportunity to have a bite on the very important Statement delivered by my good Friend, Member of Parliament for Bunkpurugu, Dr Abed-Nego Bandim.

Mr Speaker, when we talk about the security situation in that part of the country, it is instructive to note that this Statement could not have come at a better time. Anyone, irrespective of their gender, sex, educational background or social standing, may become a missing person. This even includes MPs. There are several reasons people go missing. Among them, Mr Speaker, are people who voluntarily run away from their homes. We may even find a lady who has been overly tortured as a result of domestic violence, and has left home and never returned. These days, it is even becoming very common to see men being tortured by their wives, and some of them voluntarily leave home and never get back.

Mr Speaker, some people go missing because they are abducted, and that is a crime. Some get missing because they are kidnapped. That is a crime. Some get missing because they have been trafficked, and that is a crime. In fact, an organised crime, of course. Mr Speaker, some people go missing as a result of health-related challenges, particularly with dementia. The brain is no longer as effective as it used to be. One can walk out of their house and never be able to make their way back, and they will be deemed missing.

Mr Speaker, armed conflict, and the maker of the Statement got it right. In paragraph four of the Statement, and if I am permitted to read, he said,

“The latest disappearance must be viewed within the context of the recent deterioration of the security environment in the North East Region. We note with concern that in mid-January 2026, police barriers in the Nalerigu and Gambaga areas were set ablaze by unknown persons.”

Of course, when we find an environment that is poisoned like this with insecurity, it is not strange for one to find people going missing. But he stated clearly that between 2001 to 2026, that is a period of 25 years, a quarter of a century, about seven people have disappeared, and it appears to be a defined trajectory, and that has called the attention of the community, and because he represents them, he is drawing the attention of this House to do something about the situation.

Mr Speaker, there are people with suicidal thoughts who sometimes go missing, and if we are lucky, we may find them dead somewhere. If we are not lucky, we will never find them again. The investigation of missing persons is a very complicated matter, and that is why in the year 2002, the Ghana Police Service found that it was an area of interest, so they established the Missing Persons Unit with people who are trained in that particular field to have the speciality to investigate that matter.

Mr Speaker, the maker of the Statement requested the police to engage the Cold Cases Unit to assist in delving

into this matter, and as much as I support that idea, I will further recommend that the Cold Cases Unit be joined with the Missing Persons Unit for them to do a good job. The maker of the Statement recommended that the Commission on Human Rights and Administrative Justice do something about this particular matter. The Ghana Police should get seriously involved. The National Commission for Civic Education should get involved, but I need to add that the Ghana Immigration Service, as it stands today, with our porous borders, should be brought into the picture. Intelligence agencies such as the National Intelligence Bureau should be brought into the picture, and, very importantly, the National Signals Bureau should be included to support the investigation of missing persons.

Mr Speaker, as I support my dear brother from Bunkpurugu, I am grateful for the opportunity to contribute to this Statement. Thank you so much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Member.

Yes, Dr Kabiru, you have the floor.

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama (NPP — Walewale): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I rise in solidarity with my brother, the Hon MP for Bunkpurugu Constituency, as he shed light on the matters that are affecting people in the Bunkpurugu constituency. The Bunkpurugu constituency is in the North East Region, where I come from, and it is only well and good that matters

affecting them are issues of national importance. I commend the Speaker and the Leadership of the House for admitting the Statement to highlight the issues that people are facing.

Mr Speaker, these occurrences are way too many to be mere coincidence. We have a consistent pattern where people are missing. Human beings are too visible to be missing. In other words, a human being is not just any animal that enters the wilderness; we will not know where the person has gone. So when we have occurrences of such matters among our people, it calls for concern.

6:20 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I also think that part of this occurrence is due to the fact that security and surveillance system within that particular enclave is so poor, in the sense that even police presence within the Bunkpurugu Constituency and several other constituencies in the region is so bad that when these matters happen, even real-time reporting for the security services to take action is not there. So, as much as I support the call for the National Commission for Civic Education and also call on the Ghana Police Service, while acknowledging the logistical constraints, to do something about this issue, I also want to urge the Hon Minister for the Interior to intensify community police engagement. It is because some of them before going missing may have had some social issues. I remember a case being reported in my constituency in the past of a missing person. That person had some

mental challenges, and the person actually went out and then could not be traced again. Similar things could happen to other people whereas other cases are genuine cases of kidnapping. It has happened in my constituency before where a young lady was declared missing when she had been kidnapped to Kumasi and the family did not know where they could locate her. But thanks to the diligence of the Ghana Police Service in the Walewale Constituency and the West Mamprusi District, we were able to locate her. These occurrences are across the country.

Mr Speaker, today, we are only talking about Bunkpurugu. I am sure in many other constituencies; we have reported cases. It is not a suggestion of wider insecurity in the country, but there are isolated cases that I think we have to advert our minds to address.

So, Mr Speaker, I will urge my Hon Colleague to call on the Hon Minister for the Interior, especially, the Ghana Police Service or the Services under him, to treat these cases and to resurrect the Cold Cases Unit. Mr Speaker, in other jurisdictions, there are cases that have been cold for the past 20 years, especially in the United States of America, but diligent investigation will lead to unravelling the circumstances surrounding those particular cases.

Mr Speaker, I think that there is a need for parliamentary support for that particular unit, so that we can bring finality. We know the law is common that for a person to be declared dead, the person should have been missing for

seven years and there will be diligent search. Without diligent search, you cannot declare the person dead. So, it means that of all the cases we have had in the past of missing cases, until a certain time, we intensify the search for these people, and we are not able to get them, we cannot declare them as dead, even though seven or more years have passed.

So, Mr Speaker, I want to join my Hon Colleague, and I want to thank you once again for the opportunity and to say that we have to do something to solve the misery of our people.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Member. Yes, you have the floor.

Prof Mahama Seidu Alidu (NDC — Tamale Central): Thank you so much, Mr Speaker, for giving me the opportunity to contribute to the Statement made by the Hon Member for Bunkpurugu.

Mr Speaker, I think when we look at the whole concept of insecurity and peace, basically, attention is always focused more on negative peace, where there is direct violence, people are killed, lives are lost and properties are destroyed. But largely, when we look at where positive peace is involved, where there is no direct conflict, but abuses of human rights, kidnapping and all that is happening in Bunkpurugu happens, very little attention is paid to this kind of scenario.

Mr Speaker, it is very important, and as the maker of the Statement has indicated, that a lot of measures need to be taken. I think one of the best ways we can do this is to look at a multi-stakeholder approach, not only the use of military and security agencies, but the involvement of the community and the individuals within the community, civil society organisations and largely civilians.

Mr Speaker, whether it is positive peace or negative peace-related violence, the implication is the same on food production from Bunkpurugu, on social cohesion and the unity among families, the whole concept of security and people's ability to move freely is hampered. So, I think it is very important, and this Statement is timely not just in Bunkpurugu, because it can happen in any part of the Northern Region. I add my voice to the recommendations made by the Hon Member, and I think when care and attention are paid to this kind of related incidents, we are going to have a better Northern Region and a better Bunkpurugu.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will proceed to give the floor to Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib.

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, thank you very much for this opportunity, and let me also celebrate my Hon Colleague for putting out such a very important Statement.

Mr Speaker, the Nakpanduri District has a documented history of chieftaincy

disputes. It also has a documented history of communal violence and highway insecurity. That is why I am extremely excited that both the Hon Minister for the Interior and his Deputies are here because this is a matter that concerns internal security management of this country.

Mr Speaker, let me just give you some history on the chieftaincy conflict and communal violence, and then you will see how this is causing more problems. The Bimbagu-Nanik dispute is the most significant security crisis of the year in 2025. It was centred on a long-standing chieftaincy feud between the Bimbagu and Nanik communities over the elevation of just a sub-chief. Nanik, Daana, was appointed to the paramount chief status by the National House of Chiefs. Still the same Bimbagu community, which considers the Nanik chieftaincy subordinate to their own, strongly opposed the elevation of Daana, and you should understand what it came with.

On the 28th February, there was a dawn attack. Armed assailants from Bimbagu factions launched a pre-dawn assault on the Nanik. Three individuals were found burned beyond recognition. A 27-year-old teacher who had just requested a transfer, and a native of Walewale, who was posted to a village two years before the incident — this was an eyewitness account. They noted that Majira had applied for transfer but was denied, and this was one of the persons who was burned. Approximately 50 houses were razed to the ground. Child remains were conveyed to the Binde

Rural Hospital, and this attack represented an escalation of the violence that had been festering since January 2024. Five hundred homes were displaced.

When you come to the cascading consequences, in March 2025, 20 basic schools were closed in the Bimbagu-Nanik community. So, children were not able to go to school. *[Interruption]* Mr Speaker, the Statement has to do with the security situation and the disappearances. So, unless, respectfully, the Hon Minister of the Interior is saying that this does not correlate with the security situation.

Mr Speaker, on health facilities, two Community-based Health Planning and Services (CHPS) compounds were burnt in the same community, and then there is also the displacement of about 1,500 people in the same community. What is the way forward? The way forward is to look at how to collaborate efforts with the security agencies to stop this. Not to have politicians also being a part of chieftaincy issues. So, whether a person belongs to the Convention People's Party (CPP) or Great Consolidated Popular Party (GCPP), we will not come and say that they support party A, B or C.

Mr Speaker, there should be a communal engagement and a stakeholder engagement to explain to the people, ably led by the Hon Minister for the Interior and the Hon Minister for National Security, on how to engage these people and also to encourage highway patrols because that is one of

the places where there is a lot of robbery. If we are able to bring all of these to the fore, the issues of people disappearing—they are human beings, they are visible, they are working and the next moment, they cannot be found. All of these things will be nipped in the bud.

Mr Speaker, with this, I want to thank you for giving me the platform. Thank you very much.

6:30 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister for the Interior?

Minister for the Interior (Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka) (MP): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I am very much aware of the rules governing Statements, which are not supposed to attract debate and also largely deviate from the content of the Statement. However, Mr Speaker, I am worried about the facts that have found itself in the Statement. I can say on authority that my Colleague, the Member of Parliament (MP) for Nakpanduri was met by the Regional Police Commander, and he told him it is only one case that has been reported. He still insisted and came to say seven have been missing. The police do not work in isolation. If something happens and we do not report to the police, they will never be able to know. We do not expect them to be, with the greatest respect, magicians or superhuman. So, I will be very grateful if my Colleague would try to liaise with the police because the most important thing for us as MPs is to be able to deal with the challenges that are in our

constituencies. If we position ourselves to be seen to be antagonistic towards the security people in our constituencies, they will find it very difficult to cooperate with us or even give us information because they would believe that they will give us information that will be distorted.

But that notwithstanding, on this particular instance, we went to court, got the court permission to go through the gentleman's call records. Unfortunately, for the three days before the incident, all the calls that he had were with their family members in his home. So, the investigation is still on, and I want to assure my Hon Colleague that we will continue to work hand-in-hand with the community and the family to be able to unravel this. We will also be interested, if he has records of any other person apart from the recent one. Please, they should come forward with it so that it can assist the security agencies to deal with it decisively.

Mr Speaker, I must admit that the challenges in that area are enormous. We are aware of the incidents for the past one and a half years; the challenges that we have been having in Bawku and its environs. We do not have any extra police officers where we can say that when something is happening, we will just pull them, as some countries would do: they call them reserve force. It is the same police officers that we have. At a point in time, we were all worried because we had to draw officers even from the Northern Region to go and support that enclave. Mr Speaker, when we had the opportunity to get these 50

armoured vehicles, Mr Speaker, the majority of the armoured cars are there.

Mr Speaker, the worrying thing is when the citizens are not willing to cooperate with the police to ensure peace in their area. For example, between 25th December, 2025 and today, the number of officers that have been shot and killed in that area is alarming. Just the day before yesterday, an officer was shot and killed. It makes it very difficult when we want to send officers there. People even go and beg that they want to be transferred. I have instances where we sit in the office and officers resign, that if they are not transferred out of that area, then they would rather resign and leave the Service. Because the citizens themselves are not helpful.

I am happy that my Colleague, Hon Kabiru Mahama was saying that we should include community policing. Community policing has to be started by the people themselves. We cannot go and impose it on them that we want to have community policing and therefore we are appointing such and such. It is the citizens that come forward to say, "We want to help you to keep the peace in our area, and we want to facilitate that." Then we take them through training and show them what to do. In all these enclaves, it is so difficult. They would rather prefer to have their guns and their ammunition hidden in their homes, on their motorbikes and their vehicles, to settle scores, rather than trying to come forward to help maintain the peace in the area. Mr Speaker, to the extent that, police officers that we put on the barrier, at checkpoints, people have courage to

go openly and fire at them and kill them. Yes! In that area. At the point that the Inspector-General of Police (IGP) had to withdraw all police officers from checkpoints and I had to insist that no, the answer is not to withdraw. We should rather be able to place them with armoured vehicles. So, when we create a situation where officers do not feel safe, and as MPs we need to work with these security people so that we will be able to create an enabling environment within that area so that the security people will be able to assist and help us.

I want to encourage my Hon Colleagues that when the time comes and our own citizens, friends, family members, and constituents—Somebody, with a greater respect, is posted to Nakpanduri, comes to see the MP, and say they want to be transferred to Accra, and we see the MP putting pressure for transfer. The rules are that we are supposed to spread even the little that we have thinly across the country. Now everybody wants to be in the big city. Everyone is putting pressure that they want the transfer. I want MPs to support us. When it comes and their constituents come forward to tell Hon Members that they want to be transferred, encourage them to also stay where they are. This is because if everybody moves to Kumasi, Accra, Takoradi, Sunyani and the big cities, who will be there to provide security for the vulnerable ones in those disadvantaged communities? So, I want to encourage my Hon Colleagues from that area to help by establishing this community policing. I can assure Hon Members that we have a whole directorate at the police headquarters that

deal with community policing. We will be swift in time to come in to assist. That is the assurance I will give.

I want the Member for Parliament to try and keep the collaboration with the Regional Police Commander so that this one that has been reported will be dealt with. Those that have not been reported, if the facts are there, please report them and we can assure the Hon Member that we will work at them. It is just too unfortunate that if any citizen has to lose his life, or has to be kidnapped, or has to go missing, we are not able to find that person swiftly. But I can assure you, Mr Speaker, and my Hon Colleagues, that we will work very hard with our own Hon Colleagues, to be able to unravel most of these difficult situation that we find ourselves in.

Mr Speaker, I want to thank my Hon Colleague for trying to draw the attention of this country, and in particular, those of us who have the privilege to work within the security environment on some of the challenges that are in his Constituency.

Thank you so much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you, Hon Minister.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh — *rose* —

I hope Hon Jerry Ahmed has taken the Leadership's turn. However, I will give you the floor. Be brief.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: I will be brief. I listened to the Minister

carefully, and in the morning when I came, I ran into the Hon Member, the Hon Colleague who made the Statement. Fact be told, he was extremely worried. I am a bit taken aback at certain differences in terms of the facts that have been put out. The Hon Minister is speaking to some facts, and the Hon Member is also speaking to some other facts, which is not encouraging. I would want to, just as the Minister is urging the Member to speak to the Police Command, I also want to respectfully urge the Minister to relate to his Colleague. We are all Colleagues here. I am just concluding on this matter. I am not sure the Member would want to allege any wild information or put out what is not right.

I am basically saying that let us have more engagement on this matter. More often than not, across the country, such conflict that escalates, it starts small. When it is not nipped in the bud, then it gets out of hand. So, I want to plead with the Minister and appeal to him. I know the Hon Member quite well. Let us see how we can work closely—not just him, but the constituencies that are nearby. This is because the Hon Member says more than 10 people are missing, and the Minister says it is only one that has been reported, that takes something away from the narrative. I think that we can do better in terms of exchanges between the

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, the Statement is clear. The Hon Member said seven; am I correct? There are seven people missing, and one has been reported to the police. I do not think there

are differences. The question is whether or not the rest of the six have been reported. If not, that is why the Minister is urging that they should report the rest to enable the police to investigate.

6:40 p.m.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, granted that the thing happened and it was not reported, yet lives have been lost. It is a matter that calls for an investigation, so I appreciate the fact that the Minister is saying it should be reported. But can we go beyond the reportage or the matter being taken to the police and the security agencies to be investigated? I want to see more exchanges between the Minister, the Member, and other Members of Parliament who are in the vicinity. That, for me, is the way out of this. These are my views.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Leadership, do we lay the Paper on the *Order Paper Addendum* then we come back to the Statement? Majority Leader?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we will take *Order Paper Addendum 2*. The items numbered 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, let us lay the item numbered 1(a) and (b) then we ask that the report be distributed then we will come back to the Statement after the distribution of the report, then we can come back to Motions. Minority Leadership?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, there is no issue; you can proceed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, presentation of Papers, the item numbered 1 (a) on the *Order Paper Addendum 2*. Being the Chairperson of the Committee, I will grant—

Mr Dafeamekpor — *rose* —

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, he should make the application.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am making the application because I am the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am not contesting that you are.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I want the Majority Leader to lay the Paper.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: The Majority Leader is engaged.

Mr Dafeamekpor: This is a Report of a Committee of the Whole.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, when I have a very competent Chief Whip, I can afford to sleep in the Chamber.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But I am giving you the opportunity to lay this Paper on my behalf.

PAPERS

By the Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee —

- (a) Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF) for 2026.
- (b) Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let us come back to the second Statement standing in the name of Hon Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe, Member of Parliament for Ada to make a Statement on domestic violence.

STATEMENT

Domestic Violence

Ms Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe (NDC — Ada): Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity. Today, I stand before this House with a heavy heart to address the pressing issues of domestic violence in our society.

We have constantly been speaking and addressing the issues of domestic violence in our society. Last year, we discussed the issue of Madam Harriet Amuzu, a mother of two who was assaulted by her husband in a viral video. Just recently, there was another case of domestic violence where a young man was seen brutalising his girlfriend in a viral video on social media.

Mr Speaker, this is absurd. This act of constant violation on women is very unacceptable. This does not just apply to women, but children and men can also be

victims. There have been equally trending videos of children being assaulted by their guardians. No woman, no man and certainly no child should ever have to go through such cruelty within a space that is supposed to offer love, safety and protection.

Mr Speaker, the marks, bruises and deep wounds on these victims speak to several levels of cruelty they suffer. No one deserves to be treated in such an inhumane manner. Domestic violence is not a private matter; it is a crime and it must be treated as such.

These incidents must serve as a wake-up call. We should not allow these situations to continue. Institutions that are meant to protect citizens are not to sit back and turn a blind eye on the rising cases of domestic violence. Action must be taken, not only to ensure justice for these victims but also to strengthen our system by educating more on domestic violence.

I would like to encourage every individual to speak up when they are in such situations and to always report to the rightful institutions. The silence will only allow this violence to continue. Know your rights and do not allow anyone to violate them.

Every Ghanaian deserves protection, respect and justice. Do not allow fear, shame or pressure to prevent you from reporting such incidents to the institutions mandated to address these matters.

Mr Speaker, would also like to call on all media personnel, the Ghana Police Service, relevant ministries and all

institutions responsible for protecting citizens to intensify their efforts in the fight against domestic violence. Continual awareness, swift intervention and strong enforcement of the law are important in protecting victims.

Together we must create a society where abuse is condemned, victims are supported and justice is rightfully served.

Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, that is the Statement ably delivered. It is now for your comments. I recognise Hon Zanetor Agyeman-Rawlings.

Dr Zanetor Agyeman-Rawlings: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to comment on the Statement made by the Second Deputy Majority Whip on domestic violence.

6:50 p.m.

This is perhaps a very opportune time to reiterate the call for Ghana to be a signatory to and ratify the African Union (AU) Convention on Ending Violence Against Women and Girls. It is a very comprehensive legal framework that is in place to eliminate and prevent these acts of violence, not just in a conflict scenario, but also domestically. And so, I would like to add my voice to support the maker of the Statement about the need to eliminate this scourge on our society, because violence against women is not just a gender issue, it is a societal issue. To a large extent, it appears to be

normalised, and we need to re-conscientise our populace to the fact that it is not normal.

One of the ways to do that is to ensure we have the necessary legal framework to put in place safeguards for women and children, specifically, and for others in general, within a domestic setting. And so, I would like to reiterate the call that Ghana ratifies and domesticates the AU Convention on Ending Violence Against Women and Girls.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister for Education?

Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, let me thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the Statement on domestic violence by Hon Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe. Mr Speaker, it is important that in Ghana, we focus more on statistics on domestic violence. You may want to categorise it as physical abuse, threatening behaviour, sexual abuse, emotional or psychological abuse and importantly, economic abuse. In some cultures, men are supposed to provide for their homes. So, when men leave the house without providing housekeeping money for the woman and for the children, that will constitute economic abuse and extend to psychological abuse of the woman.

Mr Speaker, we must also move away from the notion that domestic abuse is peculiarly women because there are men who are beaten at home by their spouses. But as a cultural barrier, the man is shy

to go and report to the Police that he has been beaten by his wife. He does not want his own parents to know that he has been beaten by his wife. So, we need to focus more on the statistics in order to understand the incidence of domestic violence and what promotes it in Ghana. Mr Speaker, if we focus more on domestic violence, as if the notion is that it is only women who are abused, then that is wrong.

So, I want to commend the maker of the Statement and add that in our educational institutions, we have seen clear cases of teachers abusing learners and learners abusing learners, and members of a community within the school environment also abusing teachers and abusing learners. I want to commend her and also to recognise that we need to respect rights. Once we have tolerance for respect of those fundamental human rights, we can have an improved regime. But I do not want to believe in the notion that domestic violence is peculiarly a case of women being abused.

The men in Ghana must learn to take responsibility, particularly in the rural areas. In my culture, it was abominable for a man to go and tell his father or his mother that he had been beaten by his wife. It was abominable in my culture. You could not dare go and report that you have been beaten by a woman. You would be seen as a very impotent person of a man.

Mr Speaker, I commend her for the Statement. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister for Tourism, Culture, and Creative Arts, you have the floor.

Minister for Tourism, Culture and Creative Arts (Ms Abba Dzifa Gomashie): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I want to commend the First Deputy Majority Whip for this timely Statement on ending domestic violence and drawing attention to it for us to consider ways in which we can protect both genders. It is true that some women are alleged to be beating their husbands, but the frequency of this violence against women is on the higher side. It is the reason it has taken on this gender of female cloak.

Mr Speaker, I also want to commend Hon Zanetor for the call for the ratification of the Convention to be looked at. It probably will not be the panacea to the problem, but it will be a good step in the right direction. Domestic violence, when it happens to children, can leave scars that remain forever. And for some, it makes them timid. It makes people shy away from speaking in public. It deters people from achieving their dreams because of that childhood trauma. I am not sure if we have professionals who are dealing with the trauma that childhood abuse leaves in children. When they grow up, and they have not been able to deal with that trauma from childhood, they also perpetuate that action; they pass it on. So, it becomes a generational problem.

Mr Speaker, you would find that often, in some communities where this is predominant, and seen as the norm and

all right, it is cloaked in what we call culture. But culture is not static. So even if that was the case that when we were growing up, women sat at home and did “nothing” and theirs was to wash the bowls, cook the food, clean the house, feed the children, bathe them, care for the sick, and all of that, even if that was what one was raised to think as culture, which may include beating a woman or a child, in today’s world, that is not acceptable anymore. Culture cannot remain static, so one gets away with the excuse that is how it is done in their community. If women are presidents in other countries, Vice President in the Republic of Ghana — we have a fine example in Prof Jane Naana Opoku-Agyemang, then we have no excuse for continuously torturing women in the name of it is our culture.

Only yesterday or the day before, I watched on television the fact that female genital mutilation is still ongoing. Now, the trend is to take them across the country to go and have the mutilation done. Mr Speaker, it is important that perhaps the Committee on Gender, Children, and Social Protection of which I am a Member, takes this up seriously and ensure that during this Sitting, we are able to have the Convention ratified and also advocate for stiffer punishments for those who defile children, traumatise and beat children, and abuse them mercilessly. We have seen these things on social media, and we wonder who these persons who are traumatising another human being are. Perhaps giving stiffer punishments would be more of a deterrent than just having the laws on our statute books.

Mr Speaker, I want to thank all contributors to this Statement and to urge that we all put our shoulders to the wheel and ensure that in our families, communities, Regions, and country, this sees the end this year, that we should not tolerate abuse of anybody’s rights or physical well-being being challenged. That said, Mr Speaker, I want to thank you very much for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. I give the floor to Hon Felicia Adjei.

Ms Felicia Adjei (NDC — Kintampo South): Thank you for the opportunity, Mr Speaker. I want to thank Hon Doyoe for making this Statement.

7:00 p.m.

Mr Speaker, domestic violence destroys families. It weakens our society. A home should be a place of safety, love and care. It is not about a man returning home, and say because he gave his wife GH¢20 to prepare dinner which his wife could not do, would beat her up and do so many things to her.

Mr Speaker, for the past three years, we have seen so many things on social media. There was an occasion when a man killed his wife all because the wife refused to have sex with him. Not that alone. We can go on and on. Mr Speaker, let me go to paragraph 3 of the Statement. It says this is a horrifying incident. It is not just a tragic story of a woman; it is a painful reminder of a silent suffering.

Mr Speaker, I hope that the Domestic Violence and Victim Support Unit (DOVVSU) and the Ghana Police will take this and work according to the way it is supposed to be. Something happened in my Constituency two weeks ago where a five-year-old girl was suffering. We did not know what was wrong with her. We took the child to the hospital before we realised that the father has been sleeping with the five-year-old girl. The father had to kill himself.

Mr Speaker, I strongly support the maker of the Statement and I hope and pray that this august House will take domestic violence seriously, and if any male Member of Parliament is abusing his wife, we take it up.

Thank you for the opportunity, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Felicia Adjei, what of if you have a Member of Parliament who is abusing her husband?

Ms Adjei: Mr Speaker, I am guided and I need your protection.

Mr Speaker, we have some men that before they request anything from their wife, they beat them. *[Laughter]* They ask, if you do not give it to them, they will beat you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Felicia Adjei, you are duly protected.

Hon Members, how many more do we take? I think we should take one more and draw the curtains.

I will give the floor to Hon Philip Fiifi Buckman.

Mr Philip Fiifi Buckman (NDC — Kwesimintsim): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, we have to stand against domestic violence. It is very gory looking at the statistics in Ghana. It is an abuse of human rights. It is not just domestic violence. Many people who engage in it do not see the other person as a human being. They just maltreat people. They do whatever they want to do against another human being.

Mr Speaker, the Constitution of Ghana protects every life, protects the dignity of every human being, irrespective of their status, gender, and religious affiliation. It is not something that we just make Statement about and let it slide. We have to take serious actions against it because the victims of domestic violence suffer perpetual psychological trauma. The victims, especially children, suffer and their confidence level is brought down. We need to do something about it. We have a myriad of laws that are against the abuse of human rights. We have a myriad of laws that speak and frown on the abuse of the rights of people.

But Mr Speaker, the most appalling aspect of it is that one goes to the police station and the authorities to report and it is the community leaders who rise and say that as one has taken their father to the court, as one has taken their father to the police, who is going to take care of you. Women are not able to speak out.

Children are not able to speak out. Mr Speaker, some even die out of the distress that they go through. So, we need to rise as a nation. We need to fortify the Department of Social Welfare to be able to stand up and do the work it is supposed to do. We need to educate ourselves that violence against human beings in any form is wrong. Violence against human beings in any form is intolerable. Violence against any person anywhere is not acceptable in our nation.

So, Mr Speaker, I support the call. I support the Statement. I would call upon all of us to see our fellow human beings, whether a woman or a man, a child, as a human being who has the right to live, a human being who has the right of dignity of living. If you go to schools, you go to offices, you go to homes, various places, rights of people are abused day in and day out, and they are not able to speak. They can speak out; let us give them the opportunity to speak out. I was thinking about where an opportunity can be created for people to report to a higher authority. Sometimes they go to DOVVSU, and they are told that “this little beating that your husband beat you, you are coming to report?”. We have to do something about it. I am speaking as a lawyer, and I know about this. Mr Speaker, we need to do something about it, but not just Statements. We need to act. The time to act is now. Say no to domestic violence.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.
[Hear! Hear!]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kyei Asamoah?

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah (NPP — Offinso North): Thank you, Mr Speaker, and let me also thank the maker of the Statement, Hon Doyoe, regarding domestic violence.

Mr Speaker, many a time, when we talk about domestic violence, we tend to focus on the physical or the sexual aspect, but studies have shown that the largest percentage of domestic violence is more emotional and this emotional violence is what tends to affect kids and they take it to their schools and onward to their workplace.

So, Mr Speaker, I know the Hon Minister for Education commented on this Statement. I want to suggest that if we want to bring down domestic violence, the education has to start right from the primary schools because it is the kids that grow up to be adults and become violent toward one another.

7:10 p.m.

So if this education is instituted at the primary level, as we grow, we tend to move away from it. Emotional violence leads to a lot of developmental issues in our country, especially in our part of the world because our culture and the incorporation of the European or Western culture do not agree much. If we can find a better approach to saying no to domestic violence happening within our institutions, then of course, we can take it to our workplace and homes.

If a child is abused at an early age, this child is likely to also commit the same when they grow up. But if we are trained

to be tolerant of one another, to appreciate the differences between each person, one could be short, one could be tall. When one is angry, one can calm down. It can bring about peace. So, this is something we, as a country, have to start working on from childhood. I believe we will be able to do that and if that is done, within the next few years, we can look at our data and we will realise that it has gone down.

So with these few words, I want to appreciate the maker of the Statement. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib): Mr Speaker, I want to contribute to this Statement. I have a personal experience I am dealing with and it has to do with domestic violence. A lady I know who is about 23 years old at the University of Ghana suffered the first abuse at the hands of another woman when she was around 16 years old. Mr Speaker, the lady lured her into believing she was the most beautiful woman and began an intimate relationship with her. And also wooed her to start smoking weed.

Mr Speaker, as I speak, this lady is still smoking weed as a result of that relationship. She is at the University. I even had to get someone from Parliament, one of the ladies who works with the rehabilitation centre, to also refer her to an asylum. This is a very beautiful and smart woman. She is unable to do anything on her own without taking any substances. She is in the house because she is unable to get a hostel at the university, and she is staying with her uncle.

Mr Speaker, the worst part is that the uncle, who is a pastor, has also been finding ways of abusing this lady. So the abuse does not only come from a man to a woman. It comes from a woman to another woman or a man to another man. It could be emotional, like we have said. It could be physical, psychological or economic. But the trauma that it comes with, when care is not taken, becomes something very serious.

Mr Speaker, let me speak to some statistics here in Ghana. About 40 per cent of women, aged 15 to 49, have experienced domestic violence. This domestic violence normally will not just come from a man beating a woman. It comes from a man who even denies the woman whatever she is expected to have intimately, including sex. Mr Speaker, about 20 per cent of men have also suffered the same abuse. And it also comes from the issue of sex and some men being beaten by women.

I know some of them and they have given me signals not to mention their names—*[Laughter]*—but Mr Speaker, I know them. Sometimes they wear smocks to conceal their body sizes. But we know. Beyond that, if we go to the Sawla-Tuna-Kalba Constituency, 61.9 per cent of women have experienced the worst form of domestic violence. My prayer is that the Member of Parliament there takes a look at it. About 16,000 have reported cases annually of domestic violence, and this actually includes both men and women.

Mr Speaker, what can we do to stop, or at least reduce the volume of domestic

violence? I think there are three major issues confronting us. One is fear. Some people may be afraid that their husbands and wives will punish them more and therefore, are unable to report. They are also afraid that it will become a stigma. They are unable to report same because the moment they report, whenever they are punished, they say, *Akandoh nā yaa*, to wit, there goes Akandoh's wife. [Laughter]

These and many more are the reasons we should educate people on the trauma that domestic violence causes in people. We should educate them to understand that reporting will not bring a stigma to them, but it will bring a resolution to the problem. That whoever causes this problem must be dealt with.

Mr Speaker, I see the Majority Chief Whip trying to put pressure on me to wrap up. I would use this opportunity to say thank you for giving me this opportunity.

Supt Rtd Peter Lanchene Toobu (NDC—Wa West): Mr Speaker, I want to thank Leadership for yielding to me to conclude on this debate.

Mr Speaker, I am grateful to have the opportunity to contribute to the Statement made by Hon Comfort Doyoe Cudjoe on domestic violence. In the year 1987, the United Nations adopted the UN Convention against Torture and Other Cruel, Inhuman or Degrading Treatment or Punishment. Interestingly, in the year 1998, before Ghana could even ratify this particular convention, the Ghana Police Service, being very

proactive, established what we called then the Women and Juvenile Unit, which was to deal with women and juvenile matters, and we used to call it WAJU for short.

On 7th September 2000, Ghana ratified the UN Convention Against Torture and four years later, that is in 2005, WAJU was rebranded, reinforced and revitalised into a new unit we called the Domestic Violence and Victim Support Unit, simply put, DOVVSU.

Mr Speaker, this addresses all forms of victims of domestic violence, and it was neutral. And from 2005 to today, 21 years down the line, if the Leader is making a Statement on domestic violence in this Chamber, it tells us that we are becoming more conscious of what is happening in society. And because of the power of social media, any little thing that happens in any part of this country, in the next moment, we are quite aware. The power of social media is making it very possible for us to even have better data to appreciate what is happening in the field of domestic violence. This Statement could not have been made at a better time than now. And the fact that she is even a woman makes it more intriguing.

These days, we hardly find women clapping their hands and insulting their husbands in public. These days, we hardly find men beating their wives and dragging them in public. That is not to say that we are out of the woods yet. There is still a lot we can do, but Ghana has come a long way since 1998. I want to take the opportunity to thank the Hon

Leader for making such a powerful Statement. I pray we will continue to do better and make Ghana a very hospitable place for domestic issues.

Mr Speaker, I am so grateful for the opportunity. Thank you so much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip, we have come to the end of this Statement.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we want to take the Motions numbered 2 and 3 on the Order Paper *Addendum 2*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, may I apply that the Majority Chief Whip moves this Motion instead of the Chairperson of the Committee?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we are aligned.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Majority Chief Whip, you may now move the Motion numbered 2.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Order 104(1)

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provisions of Standing Order 104(1) which require that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is given, the Motion for the adoption of the

Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF) for 2026 may be *moved* today.

7:20 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved.

Any seconder?

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we now move the consequential Motion numbered 3, and I would call on the Hon Majority Chief Whip to move the Motion.

Proposed Formula for Disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF) for 2026.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF) for 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved.

Any seconder?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am not sure about the procedure, but I thought once he has moved it, he should present the report of the Committee. He has been given the power of attorney.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I seek your leave, being the Chairperson of the Committee, to do this on your behalf.

Mr Speaker, in moving the Motion, I will present the report of the Committee.

Introduction

The Proposed Formula for disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund was presented to Parliament on Tuesday, 4th February, 2026. In accordance with article 103(3) of the 1992 Constitution and Order 261 of the Standing Orders of the House, the Rt. Hon. Speaker referred the Formula to the Committee of the Whole for consideration and report.

Acknowledgement

The Committee of the Whole met on Tuesday, 10th February, 2026 to consider the referral. In attendance at the Committee's deliberations were the Hon Minister for Health, Hon Kwabena Mintah Akandoh, the Deputy Minister for Health, Hon Prof. Grace Ayensu-Danquah, the Chief Executive Officer of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF), Ms. Adjoa Obuobia Darko-Opoku, and officials from the institution. The Committee is grateful to them for their

cooperation and clarifications during deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee, during its deliberations, referred to the following documents:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament
- iii. The National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852) as amended by the National Health Insurance (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 888)
- iv. The Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act, 2025 (Act 1144)
- v. The National Insurance Act, 2006 (Act 724)
- vi. The Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Formula for Disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2025
- vii. The Formula for Disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund for 2026

Background

In line with Ghana's broader health policy objectives of equitable, accessible, and affordable healthcare, the Government of Ghana established the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF) under the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act, 2025 (Act 1144).

The GMTF was created to mobilize, manage, and allocate resources to finance specialized medical care, with a particular focus on Non-Communicable Diseases (NCDs) and chronic medical conditions.

Equity is a guiding principle of the GMTF, consistent with the health sector's goal of bridging regional and socioeconomic disparities in healthcare access. The Fund complements the NHIS by addressing financing gaps in high-cost and specialized medical services, ensuring that all Ghanaians, particularly the poor and vulnerable, can access quality and life-saving care without suffering financial hardship.

The GMTF serves as a key vehicle for strengthening specialized healthcare through sustainable financing, infrastructure development, and capacity building for chronic and non-communicable disease care. Building on its 2025 foundation, the 2026 allocation formula emphasizes hospital retooling, specialist training, and patient support. This approach is designed to enhance health system resilience, ensure fiscal sustainability, and guarantee equitable access to essential medical care for all Ghanaians.

Object of the Fund

The object of the Fund, as provided under section 2 of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act, 2025 (Act 1144), is to mobilise resources to finance and support the provision of specialised medical care for persons with chronic and non-communicable diseases.

In furtherance of this object, moneys from the Fund shall be applied to:

- i. Provide financial support to approved persons accessing specialised medical care for chronic diseases;
- ii. Facilitate the provision of or access to specialised medical care for the treatment of persons with chronic diseases;
- iii. Invest in programmes that promote equitable access to specialised medical care;
- iv. Provide financial support for specialist medical training and research relevant to chronic diseases; and
- v. Invest in other facilitating programmes, including medical equipment, infrastructure, human resource development, and research.

Sources of the Fund

The sources of the Fund, as specified under section 3 of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Act, 2025 (Act 1144), are as follows:

- i. Twenty percent (20%) of the total moneys allocated to the National Health Insurance Fund (NHIF);
- ii. Moneys approved by Parliament;
- iii. Moneys accruing to the Fund from investments;

- iv. Grants, donations, gifts, and other voluntary contributions made to the Fund; and
- v. Any other money or property that may lawfully become payable to or vested in the Board of Trustees

donations. The projected revenues are derived primarily from the statutory allocation of twenty percent (20%) of the National Health Insurance Fund, disinvestment from existing investments, projected investment income, and anticipated grants and donations.

Revenue Projections and Sources For 2026

The Authority expects to receive a total amount of GH¢2,900.73 million in 2026 from its mandated sources, investment activities, and grants and

The detailed composition of the projected revenues is presented in Table 2 below.

The breakdown of the projections is shown in Table 2.

Table 2- Summary of Revenue Sources for the 2026 Fiscal Year

Sources	Amount Gh¢ million	%
Transfer from NHIL (20%)	2,300.00	79.29
Disinvestment	200.00	6.89
Investment Income	55.10	1.90
Grants and Donations	345.63	11.92
Total	2,900.73	100.00

The Proposed Formula for the Disbursement of The GMTF Component of the NHIF for the Year 2026

The proposed Formula seeks to ensure the sustainable financing of specialised medical care while promoting equitable access, strengthening health infrastructure, building specialist capacity, and supporting effective administration of the Fund.

The Formula prioritises patient claims for chronic and non-communicable diseases, retooling of hospitals, specialist medical training, nationwide ICT integration, and targeted interventions to bridge regional and socio-economic disparities in access to specialised healthcare services.

Table 4 contains a summary of the proposed Formula for the disbursement of the funds for 2026 as follows:

Table 4 - Summary of the Proposed Formula for the Disbursement of the GMTF Component of the NHIF for the Year 2026

Details	Notes (Section Reference)	GH¢'m	%
Specialized Medical Care (Patient Claims/Relief)	Section 8.1	1,603.05	55.26
Facilitation of Provision/Access to Specialized Medical Care	Section 8.2	1.76	0.06
Investment in Programs for Equitable Access	Section 8.3	20.00	0.69
Specialist Medical Training and Research	Section 8.4	44.21	1.52
Hospital Infrastructure and Equipment Investment	Section 8.5	975.56	33.64
GMTF Operational Costs (Administration & Secretariat)	Section 8.6	142.97	4.90
GMTF Nationwide ICT Operational Costs	Section 8.7	101.83	3.51
Fundraising Activities & Investments	Section 8.8	5.64	0.19
Emergency Support for Public Health Interventions	Section 8.9	0.70	0.02
Contingency	Section 8.10	5.00	0.18
Total NHIS Allocation	Section 8.1	2,900.73	100.00

Committee Observations and Recommendations Health Infrastructure and Diagnostic Equipment Financing

Based on the Fund's own needs assessment, the Committee observed severe shortages in essential diagnostic and treatment equipment across teaching and regional hospitals. While infrastructure allocations were included in the budget formula, the Committee found these amounts to be inadequate relative to the scale of identified gaps. It therefore stresses the need for more detailed disclosure of infrastructure

spending, including beneficiary facilities, equipment specifications, and alignment with assessed needs. The Committee further noted that the significant 2025 cash balance presents an opportunity to accelerate equipment procurement through mid-year budget adjustments.

Human Resource Planning and Compensation Controls

The Committee expressed concern about the level of expenditure on staff compensation in relation to the Fund's

current and projected staffing levels. While recognising the importance of skilled personnel and regional coordination, the Committee observed that the absence of a clear human resource plan limits Parliament's ability to assess value for money. It therefore recommends that future budget submissions be supported by comprehensive staffing plans detailing staff categories, deployment, and cost benchmarks relative to comparable public institutions.

Conclusion

The Committee, having carefully examined the Proposed Formula for the Disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund Component National Health Insurance Fund for the year 2026, is satisfied that the Formula broadly reflects Government's commitment to improving access to healthcare, strengthening specialised medical services, and ensuring equity in health financing.

The Committee, therefore, recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the sum of GH¢2,900,730,000.00 for the year ending 31st December, 2026, in line with the Distribution Formula, to enable the National Health Insurance Authority and the Ghana Medical Trust Fund to effectively discharge their respective mandates.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved and Report presented.

Any seconder?

Chairperson of the Committee on Health (Dr Mark Kurt Nawaane): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Chairperson of Health Committee, you seconded the Motion. If you have any contribution, please do so.

Dr Nawaane: Mr Speaker, I would want to say that the Ghana Medical Trust Fund is the best thing that has happened in Ghana for the year 2025. For the first time, we are tackling the chronic diseases. We are going to provide specialist care, and Ghanaians are going to really feel the medical care for those who hitherto could not afford specialist care. I must say that there was a little bit of talk about equipment, *et cetera*, and I have to say that Ghana is not Accra. We have regional hospitals—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Chairperson, in conclusion? [*Laughter*]

Dr Nawaane: Yes, others who do not have the equipment—

In conclusion, I would want to say that the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF) has come to fill a gap in the healthcare sector, and we must say thank you to His Excellency, the President of the Republic of Ghana, for resetting the medical field. [*Hear! Hear!*]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr Issac Boamah-Nyarko (NPP — Effia): Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity to comment on the report laid by your Committee.

Mr Speaker, the Ghana Medical Trust Fund is a new fund and this is the first time, as a House, we are considering approving a formula for it. Last year, when the Fund was created or the body was created to administer it, some financial commitments were made. From the Report, close to about GH¢700 million was received for the year 2025.

Mr Speaker, the concern is that how many beneficiaries can we clearly see have benefited from the establishment of the Fund, and more importantly, the resource allocation that we are looking at for 2026? Where exactly are we putting our eggs in this regard by the close of the year?

Mr Speaker, from the Report of the Committee, under the item numbered 9 (2), talking about Human Resource Planning and Compensation Control, it states, and I read:

“The Committee expressed concern about the level of expenditure on staff compensation in relation to the Fund’s current and projected staffing level.”

This, for me, is very instructive, because we are creating this medical trust fund with a sole aim of promoting and curing the ailments of our people. But where the Fund is using substantial amounts of money to cater for staff compensation, as well as other

matters of expenditure which do not relate to the core business of the Fund, then it causes for this House to be worried. I am of the respectful opinion that management of the Fund be much more guided in ensuring that the focus of this particular Fund is relied upon, it is looked at closely, rather than putting much emphasis on compensation.

Mr Speaker, subsequent issues around the building of infrastructure —

7:30 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Boamah-Nyarko, if compensation is not paid to the workers of the Trust, how do they get their salary?

Mr Boamah-Nyarko: Mr Speaker, of course, once we established the Trust, we indicated that there would be recruitment of staff. Everybody knows that staff will be paid compensation. But I am referencing the Committee’s Report that expressed concern about the extent of expenditure on staff compensation, both now and the projected future. I think this is where my comment is being relied upon. Mr Speaker, you may look at the item numbered 9.2 of the Committee’s Report. It is only for us to be guided and be mindful. This is an advice I am giving to the Fund, that we focus on the majors and limit the minors, so that at the end of the day, the sole objective of this Fund will be achieved.

Mr Speaker, I was just concluding with respect to expenditures around infrastructural development among others. I know that as a new entity, there would always be the need for them to

also pay for buildings and equipment, but we are also supposed to check how much it is costing the taxpayer in terms of these expenses and the buildings and the equipment that will be procured. I am appealing to the management of the Fund that they be very careful and be guided by efficiency in terms of the management of this particular resource, so that at the end of the day, the majority of Ghanaians will benefit.

Without more, Mr Speaker, I want to call on this House to support this particular Report. I so thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, it is clear.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund (GMTF) for 2026.

MOTIONS

Suspension of Standing Order 104(1)

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That notwithstanding the provisions of Standing Order 104(1) which require that a Motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the Motion is

given, the Motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2026 may be moved today.

Chairperson of the Committee on Health (Dr Mark Kurt Nawaane): Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Report of the Committee of the Whole on Formula of the National Health Insurance Fund, 2026

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2026.

Mr Speaker, I present the Committee's Report.

Introduction

The Proposed Formula for disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2026 was presented to Parliament on Tuesday, 4th February, 2026. In accordance with Article 103(3) of the 1992 Constitution and Order 261 of the Standing Orders of the House, the Rt Hon Speaker referred the Formula to the Committee of the Whole for consideration and report.

Acknowledgement

The Committee of the Whole met on Tuesday, 10th February, 2026 to consider the referral. In attendance at the Committee's deliberations were the Hon Minister for Health, Mr Kwabena Mintah Akandoh, the Hon Deputy Minister for Health, Prof. Grace Ayensu-Danquah, the Chief Executive Officer of the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA), Dr Victor Bampoe, and officials from the Authority. The Committee is grateful to them for their cooperation and clarifications during deliberations.

Reference Documents

The Committee during its deliberations referred to the following documents:

- viii. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana
- ix. The Standing Orders of Parliament
- x. The National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852) as amended by the National Health Insurance (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 888)
- xi. The National Insurance Act, 2006 (Act 724)
- xii. The Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Formula for Disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2025
- xiii. The Formula for Disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2026

Background

The National Health Insurance Scheme (NHIS) was established under the National Health Insurance Act, 2003 (Act 650) to provide financial risk protection against the cost of quality basic healthcare for all residents in Ghana. Act 650 was later repealed and replaced by the National Health Insurance Act, 2012 (Act 852), which created the National Health Insurance Authority (NHIA) to oversee the implementation of the national health insurance policy. Section 39 of Act 852 established the National Health Insurance Fund (NHIF), managed by the NHIA Board, as the financing mechanism for the Scheme. Subsequently, the National Health Insurance Act, 2015 (Act 888) amended Act 852 to limit the scope of exemptions in respect of supplies, thereby strengthening the financial sustainability of the Fund.

Object of the Fund

The object of the Fund is to pay for healthcare services of members of the National Health Insurance Scheme. For purposes of implementing the object of the Fund as provided for under section 40(2) of Act 852, moneys from the Fund shall be expended as follows:

- i. To pay for the healthcare costs of members of the National Health Insurance Scheme
- ii. To pay for approved administrative expenses in relation to running the National Health Insurance Scheme

- iii. To facilitate the provision of access to healthcare services
- iv. To undertake investments to promote access to healthcare services as may be determined by the Minister for Health in consultation with the Board of the Authority

v. Grants, donations, gifts and any other voluntary contributions made to the Fund;

vi. Fees charged by the Authority in the performance of its functions;

vii. Contributions made by members of the Scheme; and

viii. Monies accruing from the National Insurance Commission under Section 198 of the Insurance Act, 2006 (Act 724).

Sources of the Fund

The sources of the Fund as specified in section 41 of Act 852 are as follows:

- i. The National Health Insurance Levy (NHIL);
- ii. Two and a half per cent (2.5 per cent) of each person's contribution to the Basic Social Security and National Insurance Trust (SSNIT) Pension Fund;
- iii. Moneys approved for the Fund by Parliament;
- iv. Moneys that accrue to the Fund from investments made by the Authority;

2025 Performance

NHIF Allocation and Expenditure for the year 2025

Total expenditure as at the year ending December 31, 2025 was **GHC 6,574.82 million**, against an annual budget of **GHC 10,075.55 million**, resulting in a budget variance of **GHC 3,500.73 million**. This represents a budget execution rate of **65.26 per cent** for the same period.

Table 1: 2025 Budget Allocations & Performance

Details	Budget	Actual	Variance	Execution Rate
		GHC Million	GHC Million	%
Claims	6,557.49	3,688.60	2,868.89	56.25%
NHIA Operational Expenses	1,234.26	1,024.77	209.49	83.03%
Support to District Offices	124.22	117.85	6.37	94.87%
Support to MOH	984.78	865.37	119.41	87.87%
Support for District Health Projects & M&E	125.53	122.11	3.42	97.28%
Claims Processing Centers	111.43	55.23	56.20	49.56%
Biometric ID Cards & Authentication	188.83	143.00	45.83	75.73%
Management Information System	423.54	315.30	108.24	74.44%
Office Buildings	106.07	48.99	57.08	46.19%
Telecare Services Platform	51.00	51.00	-	100.00%
Archival System	18.40	10.79	7.61	58.64%
Support for Health-related Research	3.00	0.20	2.80	6.67%
Sensitization, Publicity, tools & Marketing	3.00	2.52	0.48	84.00%
Claims Data Capturing	20.00	18.89	1.11	94.45%
Data Integration, Transfer and Maintenance	5.00	-	5.00	0.00%
Corporate Social Responsibility	50.00	49.78	0.22	99.56%
Call Center	5.00	1.27	3.73	25.40%
E-Pharmacy	13.00	12.95	0.05	99.62%
Government Agencies on USAID	50.00	46.20	3.80	92.40%
Contingency	1.00	-	1.00	0.00%
Total	10,075.55	6,574.82	3,500.73	65.26%

Comparative Analysis of NHIL/SSNIT Collections and Receipts for 2025

The Authority's budget for NHIL/SSNIT for 2025 was **GHC 9,764.97 million**, as derived from the Government of Ghana budget statements. However NHIL/SSNIT collections or warrants for period ending December 31, 2025 was **GHC8,869.24 million**. It should however be noted that actual amount received in 2025 from Government amounted to **GHC8,078.09million**, all of which relates to the year 2025.

Table 2: Annual Budget against Reported Collections (NHIL & SSNIT)- 2025

Year	Budgeted Collection GHC Million	Reported Collections GHC Million	Difference GHC Million	Difference %
2023	4,272.00	4,004.16	-267.84	-6.27%
2024	6,523.03	7,201.82	678.79	10.41%
2025	9,764.97	8,869.24	-895.73	-9.17%

Table 3: Reported Collection (NHIL & SSNIT) Against Actual Releases from MOFEP

Year	Reported Collections GHC Million	Releases GHC Million	Difference GHC Million	Difference %
2023	4,004.16	965.73	-3,038.43	-75.88%
2024	7,201.82	2,800.75	-4,401.07	-61.11%
2025	8,869.24	8,078.09	-791.15	-8.92%

Table 4: Annual Budget Against Actual Releases for the Year

Year	Budgeted Collection GHC Million	Releases GHC Million	Difference GHC Million	Difference %
2023	4,272.00	965.73	-3306.27	-77.39%
2024	6,523.03	2,800.75	-3,722.28	-57.06%
2025	9,764.97	8,078.09	-1,686.88	-17.27%

Table 5: Annual Budget Against Actual Cash Received in the Year

Year	Budgeted Collection GHC Million	Releases GHC Million	Difference GHC Million	Difference %
2023	6,523.03	3,795.84	-2,727.19	-41.81%
2024	6,523.03	5,953.78	-569.25	-8.73%
2025	9,764.97	8,078.09	-1,686.88	-17.27%

Table 6 Comparative Analysis of Other Revenues as of 31st December 2025

	Budget GhC Million	Actual GhC Million	% Execution
Premium & Processing Fees	156.63	127.48	81%
Investment Income	41.82	47.65	114%
Bilateral Donors	110.33	42.44	38%
Other Income	1.80	1.47	82%
Total	310.58	219.04	71%

Investments Over the Period 2025

The Authority's Investments are in fixed deposits with financial institutions, mostly banks. The value of the Investment as at January 1, 2025 was **GHC243.10 million**. The investment portfolio earned a total interest of **GHC47.65 million** for the period under review in 2025. The balance as at December 31, 2025, stood at **GHC486.75 million**.

Revenue Projections and Sources for 2026

The Authority expects to receive a total amount of **GHC9,270.06 million** in 2026 from National Health Insurance Levy (NHIL), SSNIT contributions, premiums, investment income, donor support and other sources to enable it to effectively execute its mandate. The projected revenue envelope reflects anticipated improvements in levy collections, premium mobilisation, and investment returns. The detailed composition of the projected revenues is presented in Table 7 below.

The breakdown of the projections is shown in Table 7 below.

Table 7- Summary of Revenue Sources for the 2026 Fiscal Year

Sources	Amount GHC million	%
Levies - NHIL & SSNIT	9,037.39	97.49
Premium (Informal)	64.00	0.69
Processing Fees	56.12	0.61
Income on Investment	53.37	0.58
Donor Funding	56.01	0.60
Other Income	3.17	0.03
Total NHIS Fund	9,270.06	100.0

The Proposed Formula for the Disbursement of the Fund for 2026

The proposed Formula seeks to balance claims payments, operational efficiency, digital investments, health system strengthening, and contingency provisioning.

Table 8 contains a summary of the proposed Formula for the disbursement of the funds for 2026 as follows:

Table 8 - Summary of the Proposed Formula for the Disbursement of the NHIF for the Year 2026

Details	GHC million	%
Claims	5,365.01	57.9%
NHIA Operational Expenses	1,439.47	15.5%
Support to District Offices	126.90	1.4%
Support to MOH	919.00	9.9%
Support for District Health Projects & M&E	173.69	1.9%
Biometric ID Cards & Authentication System	97.63	1.1%
Management Information System	508.61	5.5%
Office Buildings	232.70	2.5%
Telecare Services Platform	46.00	0.5%
Archival System	18.40	0.2%
Support for Health-related Research	2.00	0.0%
Sensitization, Publicity, tools & Marketing	9.65	0.1%
Claims Data Captured	20.00	0.2%
Data Integration, Transfer and Maintenance	120.00	1.3%
Corporate Social Responsibility	65.00	0.7%
Medical Equipment for Selected Health Facilities	100.00	1.1%
Call Center	2.00	0.0%
Counterpart funding for Government Agencies on USAID funded programs	23.00	0.2%
Contingency	1.00	0.0%
Total	9,270.06	

Committee Observations and Recommendations National Health Insurance Authority

Claims Classification, Reporting, and Outstanding Liabilities

The Committee observed significant discrepancies between approved claims budgets and actual payments during the 2025 financial year. These variances raised concerns about the treatment of outstanding claims and the interpretation of execution rates. The Committee therefore emphasised the need for future budget formulas to clearly distinguish between claims incurred, reported, settled, and paid, with outstanding claims transparently disclosed and integrated into subsequent financial planning.

Beneficiary Identification and System Independence

The Committee observed growing operational risks associated with the Authority's reliance on external beneficiary identification systems, particularly those managed by the National Identification Authority. Persistent challenges in system availability and card production have affected service delivery.

The Committee therefore recommends a comprehensive review of beneficiary identification arrangements, with a view to enhancing system reliability, improving client experience, and

aligning processes with the forthcoming Free Primary Healthcare programme.

Information Technology Contracts Expiry and System Continuity

The Committee noted that several of the Authority's existing Information Technology contracts are due to expire within the next one to two years and that the Authority does not intend to renew most of them. While acknowledging the potential benefits of reviewing and rationalising IT arrangements, the Committee expressed concern about the risk of service disruption in the absence of a clear transition plan. The Committee therefore recommends that the Authority develops a comprehensive IT transition and sustainability strategy to ensure system continuity, safeguard data integrity, and support uninterrupted service delivery, while strengthening internal technical capacity and ensuring value for money in future digital investments.

Revenue Mobilisation and Long-Term Financial Stability of NHIA

The Committee observed that persistent funding gaps pose a serious risk to the long-term viability of the National Health Insurance Scheme. In light of rising obligations and limited revenue growth, the Committee strongly recommends that Government explores additional and sustainable revenue sources to support the Authority, in order to avert financial distress and protect access to essential healthcare services.

Conclusion

The Committee, having carefully examined the Proposed Formula for the Disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for the year 2026 is satisfied that the Formula broadly reflects Government's commitment to improving access to healthcare, strengthening specialised medical services, and ensuring equity in health financing.

The Committee, therefore, recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the **sum Nine Billion, Two Hundred and Seventy Million, Sixty Thousand Ghana Cedis and Six Pesewas (GH¢9,270.06 million)** for the year ending **31st December, 2026**, in line with the Distribution Formula, to enable the National Health Insurance Authority to effectively discharge its mandate.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved and Report presented, Any seconder? Yes, Chairperson of the Committee on Health?

Chairperson of the Committee on Health (Dr Mark Kurt Nawaane): Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

I want the House to take note of the following, that the amount allocated for claims has increased. We have gotten about GH¢3.6 billion, now moving to GH¢5.06 billion, that is an increase that incorporates the primary health care. So this year, we are going to roll out the primary health care, and that amount is incorporated in this claim. We also have an allocation of about GH¢9.9 million to

the Ministry of Health to carry out its activities. Under the Ministry of Health, we have the HIV/AIDS programme, Malaria programme, the TB programme, and the vaccine. We are now moving towards self-sufficiency in the provision of vaccines, and all that is provided in the formula. Indeed, the total amount allocated is GH¢ 9.27 billion, and I hope that this year, things will be better than last year, and we also hope that we will be able to carry out our infrastructure programmes that we have budgeted for. Thank you.

Question proposed

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, I rise to speak in support of the Motion for the adoption of the Report related to the NHIF formula. Mr Speaker, let me begin by acknowledging the Minister's intervention on a number of popular calls, both from Leadership and Members of Parliament, which the Minister responded positively. I do not need to elucidate on this. I am commending him. He did well. He and the Chief Executive did very well by responding to calls from Members.

Mr Speaker, at the Committee of the Whole, a number of concerns were brought up, and I hope the Minister paid attention to it.

7:40 p.m.

By the way, if we look at page 8, item 10.0, we need to make some corrections to that page. Mr Speaker, with your leave I read: "The Committee having carefully

examined the proposed formula for the disbursement of the Ghana Medical Trust Fund”, it should not be Ghana Medical Trust Fund, it should be the NHIF, so if we could correct that. We have already taken the report on the Ghana Medical Trust Fund.

Mr Speaker, page 4, where it talks about 2025 performance, it is just half a page. This is Parliament of Ghana; it cannot just be half a page. It is totally unacceptable. Are they telling me that from all the funding that was given to them for 2025, this is all they can talk about when it comes to performance? This is not how we report on previous performance. I do not think it is impressive. I am speaking in support of the adoption of the report, but I think next time, the Committee leadership—the Chairperson is here, we can do better in terms of performance report.

I see also on page 8, this is repeated. Last year, it was the same thing, “Corporate Social Responsibility”. It is just a line. But I know they have done a lot of projects regarding Corporate Social Responsibilities. At least they could flesh it up a bit for us to appreciate what the fund is doing. I am aware of an intervention in my constituency. I am not saying they should list everything, but at least they cannot just say Corporate Social Responsibility and put there a figure. That is not enough. So, the Chairperson may have to take a look at it. I cannot zero in on just the Chairperson; he and the Committee leadership should do better next time. This is not acceptable to Parliament.

Mr Speaker, we can also report better on donor fund and then the counterpart funding. The World Bank and United Nations Children’s fund (UNICEF) are supporting us. We should be fleshing how funding from the UNICEF and the World Bank, has supported the NHIF. We have to speak to it. We cannot just quote figures and say this amount came from World Bank, this amount came from UNICEF then it ends there. I think we can do better. The Hon Minister should take good notice.

Lastly, I drew the Hon Minister’s attention to the IT architecture, which he personified a fight for an investigation in his other world when he was a Ranking Member. He was all over the country. In fact, I admired him for that. Suddenly, he has forgotten about it. I see scanty statements saying that he is going to review it. Yes, he will review it, but what happened to the previous call where he said that there should be proper audits of how the fund was used in terms of IT facility? The Minister knows he is my friend. Let us do things properly.

Mr Speaker, having said this, I support the adoption of the Report, but I particularly want to appeal to the Minister that, going into the future, he should pay attention to these observations we have made. I thank you, Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my attention has been drawn to some clerical error regarding the figure. In presenting

my Report, I indicated that the total amount available was GH¢9,261,010,000. But the accurate figure is actually GH¢9,270,060,000. So, this is the small amendment in respect of the total sum available to be disbursed. Thank you very much, Mr. Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, take note of the correct figure that should be in the Report.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee of the Whole on the Proposed Formula for disbursement of the National Health Insurance Fund for 2026.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader, any indication? Are we going back to Statements?

Mr Dafeamekpor: It is 10 minutes to 8:00 p.m. We have done more than five hours, so, Mr Speaker, we are in your hands.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, it is indeed true that we have done more than five hours, therefore Order 56 (2) would apply.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was adjourned at 7:49 p.m. till Wednesday, 11th February, 2026 at 2 o'clock in the afternoon.

Editor's Note

This *Official Report* was corrected by the House on 18th February, 2026.

Column 26, paragraph 1, line 2, “Dr” was changed to “Mr”.